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Proposed programme budget for 2027

Proposed programme budget for 2027

Part II
Political affairs

Section 3
Political affairs

Special political missions

Estimates in respect of special political missions

Summary

The present report is the first addendum to the report of the Secretary-General on the proposed programme budget for 2027 under section 3, Political affairs, and contains information on the overall resource requirements of 36 special political missions authorized by the General Assembly and/or the Security Council.

The report describes the continued relevance and effectiveness of the contributions of special political missions to the prevention and resolution of violent conflict and to peacebuilding within an evolving global context and increasingly challenging operational environments. In addition, it provides details of efforts undertaken and planned to strengthen a culture of efficiency in special political missions, including quantifiable savings achieved.

The overall proposed resource requirements of special political missions for 2027 amount to $422,671,000 (net of staff assessment). The requirements include $3,259,100 to provide for the share of special political missions for the financing of the budget of the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe, Uganda, for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027. Detailed information in respect of each special political mission is contained in three addenda to section 3, Political affairs (A/81/6 (Sect. 3)/Add.2, A/81/6 (Sect. 3)/Add.3 and A/81/6 (Sect. 3)/Add.4), corresponding to three thematic clusters, with the resource requirements for the United Nations Assistance Mission in Afghanistan now incorporated into the report on thematic cluster III.

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I. Introduction

1. Special political missions continued to play a vital role in the maintenance of international peace and security by contributing to the prevention and resolution of violent conflict and to peacebuilding in some of the world's most complex contexts. Such missions perform a wide spectrum of critical functions, from engaging in preventive diplomacy and supporting the implementation of peace agreements to assisting Member States in the promotion of human rights, enhancing the meaningful participation of women and advancing the engagement of young people and other marginalized constituencies in political and peace processes. They also play a key role in strengthening the partnerships between the United Nations and regional and subregional organizations. Across all these areas, special political missions cooperate closely with United Nations development, human rights and humanitarian entities to implement integrated and effective responses.

2. The appropriation for special political missions for 2026 amounted to $536.1 million, representing a decrease of 22.6 per cent compared with the 2025 appropriation of $693.0 million, due primarily to the implementation of efficiency measures under the UN80 Initiative, as well as the liquidation and closure of three missions: the United Nations Assistance Mission for Iraq (UNAMI), the United Nations Transitional Assistance Mission in Somalia (UNTMIS) and the United Nations Mission to Support the Hudaydah Agreement (UNMHA).

3. The proposed budget for 2027 builds on the momentum of the UN80 Initiative and is intended to minimize resource growth while continuing to pursue efficiencies, where feasible. The proposed budget amounts to $422.7 million, representing a decrease of $113.5 million, or 21.2 per cent, compared with the approved budget for 2026. The net decrease is attributable to: (a) a decrease of $121.5 million due to the closure of the three missions noted in paragraph 2 above; and (b) an increase of $8.0 million attributable to the 36 continuing missions, including an increase of $0.9 million for the share of special political missions in the cost of the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe, Uganda (RSCE). In terms of staffing, the proposed budget reflects an overall decrease of 89 posts and positions, including a reduction of 4 higher-level posts (D-1 and above).

4. The proposed budget reflects the collective effort of missions, supported by Headquarters, to maximize cost reductions and efficiency gains while maintaining effective mandate delivery. These efforts build on a systematic process to enhance cost-effectiveness embarked upon by special political missions in the past few years, culminating in the launch in January 2025 of a strategic approach to a culture of efficiency. This initiative is designed to transform discrete efficiency initiatives into a global, coherent, systematic and consistent approach for all field missions. Efficiency initiatives resulted in actual savings of $16.8 million in 2025, while projected savings for 2026, initially estimated at $12.7 million (or 2.1 per cent of the approved 2025 budget) in the proposed budget, increased to reflect additional reductions of $96.3 million (or 15 per cent) under the revised estimates (A/80/400). The commitment to this culture of efficiency enables missions to reflect targeted efficiencies in their budget proposals for 2027 estimated at $14.7 million (or 3.6 per cent of the approved 2026 budget for these missions).

5. The full implementation of the programme budget continues to be impacted by the current liquidity situation. To operate within these liquidity constraints, cash conservation measures and hiring freezes have been implemented. For special political missions, the liquidity situation has also required that new and expanded mandates be accommodated largely within existing resources. This means that budget performance (and the pattern of expenditure from the prior year) is no longer an indicator of mission requirements and implementation capacities.

6. In line with budgetary practices, any adjustments to the resource requirements emanating from additional mandates or changes in mandates will be presented to the General Assembly either as additional reports of the Secretary-General on estimates resulting from such changes of mandates or as supplementary information or updates during the legislative review prior to the approval of budgets. Given the volatility of the security and operating environments of special political missions, should any changes from such environments significantly alter the planning assumptions and costing parameters applied in the current budget, and if such changes cannot be absorbed from existing

resources, the consequent changes to either resource or staffing requirements will be brought to the attention of the Assembly, as appropriate, in accordance with established practices and procedures, and pursuant to the Financial Regulations and Rules of the United Nations.

A. Organization of reports

7. In accordance with established practice, the budget requirements of special political missions are presented as addenda to section 3, Political affairs, of the proposed programme budget, and organized in three thematic clusters. Further details of the individual missions are presented in the following reports:

   (a) Thematic cluster I: special and personal envoys, advisers and representatives of the Secretary-General (A/81/6 (Sect. 3)/Add.2);

   (b) Thematic cluster II: sanctions monitoring teams, groups and panels, and other entities and mechanisms (A/81/6 (Sect. 3)/Add.3);

   (c) Thematic cluster III: regional offices, offices in support of political processes and other missions (A/81/6 (Sect. 3)/Add.4).

8. One change to the organization of reports for 2027 relates to the United Nations Assistance Mission in Afghanistan (UNAMA). Previously, the budgets of UNAMA and of UNAMI (now closed and undergoing liquidation), notwithstanding both being part of thematic cluster III, were presented separately in stand-alone reports. This was the result of a practice introduced in 2007, at a time when UNAMA and UNAMI collectively represented two thirds of the total resources for special political missions. It is recalled that the General Assembly, in its resolution 59/276, endorsed the recommendations of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions (A/59/569/Add.1, paras. 6 and 7) that the magnitude and complexity of large political missions, such as UNAMA and UNAMI, created new challenges in respect of effective consideration of resource requirements for special political missions and that, while maintaining the overall benefits of consolidated reporting for most special political missions, the Secretary-General should consider ways and means to present the budgets of large missions in a manner that would be more suitable for their size and complexity. To facilitate consideration, the Advisory Committee was of the view that thought should be given to reorganizing the report on special political missions so that the missions would be presented in clusters on the basis of thematic or regional considerations, as appropriate. Reflecting the evolution of mandates and resource requirements over the past two decades, particularly following the closure of UNAMI in 2025, the proposed budget for UNAMA is now comparable in size to those of other large missions within thematic cluster III. Accordingly, the budget requirements for UNAMA are integrated into the report on thematic cluster III, beginning from the 2027 budget period. This integration enables a more harmonized structure and presentation across missions of similar magnitude and size, as well as a more enriched presentation of resource requirements for all missions under thematic cluster III.

B. Status of the extension or renewal of mandates

9. Of the 36 special political missions for which resource requirements are proposed for 2027, 15 have open-ended mandates, 9 have mandates extended into 2027 or later and 12 have mandates expiring in 2026 and pending extension by the General Assembly or the Security Council, as detailed below:

   (a) Special political missions with open-ended mandates:

      (i) Mission of the Secretary-General's Good Offices in Cyprus;[1]

[1] The position of the Special Adviser to the Secretary-General on Cyprus was discontinued as from 1 January 2026 following the approval by the General Assembly of the proposal made in the revised estimates for the proposed programme budget for 2026 and the support account for peacekeeping operations for the 2025/26 period (A/80/400). Accordingly, the name of the mission is adjusted from the Office of the Special Adviser to the Secretary-General on Cyprus to the current name.

(ii) Office of the Special Adviser to the Secretary-General on the Prevention of Genocide;

(iii) Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for Western Sahara;

(iv) Support for the implementation of Security Council resolution 1559 (2004);[2]

(v) Office of the United Nations Representative to the Geneva International Discussions;

(vi) Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Syria;

(vii) Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Horn of Africa;

(viii) Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Great Lakes Region;

(ix) Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen;

(x) Office of the Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Sudan;

(xi) Support to the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1718 (2006);

(xii) Office of the Focal Point for Delisting;

(xiii) United Nations Regional Centre for Preventive Diplomacy for Central Asia;

(xiv) United Nations support for the Cameroon-Nigeria Mixed Commission;

(xv) Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon;

(b) Special political missions with mandates renewed or extended into 2027 or later:

(i) Senior Representative for the implementation of Security Council resolution 2792 (2025);

(ii) Panel of Experts on Libya;

(iii) Analytical Support and Sanctions Monitoring Team pursuant to Security Council resolutions 1526 (2004) and 2253 (2015) concerning Islamic State in Iraq and the Levant (Da'esh), Al-Qaida and the Taliban and associated individuals and entities;

(iv) Office of the Ombudsperson established pursuant to Security Council resolution 1904 (2009);

(v) Support to the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1540 (2004) on the non-proliferation of all weapons of mass destruction;

(vi) Counter-Terrorism Committee Executive Directorate;

(vii) United Nations Office for West Africa and the Sahel (UNOWAS);

(viii) United Nations Regional Office for Central Africa (UNOCA);

(ix) United Nations Integrated Office in Haiti (BINUH);

(c) Special political missions with mandates expiring in 2026 pending extension into 2027 or later:

(i) Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General on Myanmar;

(ii) Group of Experts on the Democratic Republic of the Congo;

(iii) Panel of Experts pursuant to resolution 2745 (2024);

(iv) Panel of Experts on Yemen;

[2] The position of Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the implementation of Security Council resolution 1559 (2004), at the level of Under-Secretary-General, is proposed for abolishment as part of efforts to enhance coherence and synergies in line with the UN80 Initiative. The functions previously exercised by the Special Envoy will be assumed by the Department of Peacebuilding and Political Affairs, led by the Under-Secretary-General for Peacebuilding and Political Affairs, and supported by dedicated capacity to implement the mandate. Accordingly, the name of the mission is adjusted from the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Implementation of Security Council resolution 1559 (2004) to the current name.

(v) Panel of Experts on South Sudan;

(vi) Panel of Experts on Haiti;

(vii) Panel of Experts on the Sudan;

(viii) Panel of Experts on the Islamic Republic of Iran;

(ix) Panel of Experts pursuant to resolution 2713 (2023);

(x) United Nations Support Mission in Libya (UNSMIL);

(xi) United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia;

(xii) UNAMA.

C. Discontinuing or discontinued missions

10. The mandate of UNAMI expired on 31 December 2025 pursuant to Security Council resolution 2732 (2024). The liquidation of UNAMI commenced on 1 January 2026 and is expected to be completed by 30 September 2026. Remaining liquidation activities will be transferred to the Department of Operational Support in New York, while activities related to logistics and property management will be conducted by the United Nations Logistics Base at Brindisi, Italy (UNLB). The Kuwait Joint Support Office will be closed by 30 June 2026, with its clients transferred to RSCE. Separately, on the issue of the missing Kuwaiti persons and property not resolved upon termination of the mandate of UNAMI, the Security Council adopted resolution 2792 (2025) and requested the Secretary-General to appoint a senior representative to promote, support and facilitate efforts regarding the repatriation or return of all Kuwaiti and third-country nationals or their remains, as well as the return of Kuwaiti property, including the national archives. The new mission was established in 2026 under thematic cluster I, as previously reported in the revised estimates (A/80/6 (Sect. 3)/Add.7).

11. The mandate of UNTMIS is set to end on 31 October 2026 pursuant to Security Council resolution 2753 (2024). Its liquidation process will start on 1 November 2026 and be executed by a small residual team until 31 December 2026, jointly with the United Nations Support Office in Somalia.

12. The mandate of UNMHA ended on 31 March 2026, pursuant to Security Council resolution 2813 (2026), which was adopted in January 2026. In the same resolution, the Council requested UNMHA to start the transfer of its residual functions to the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen. The liquidation budget of UNMHA and the proposal for the transfer of residual functions to the Office were reported in the revised estimates (A/80/6 (Sect. 3)/Add.7). The liquidation process commenced on 1 April 2026 and is expected to be completed by 30 June 2026.

13. No resources are required for 2027 for the three discontinuing or discontinued missions.

II. Delivering mandates in an evolving global context

A. Performance information

14. The special envoys and advisers appointed by the Secretary-General, presented under thematic cluster I, continued to offer good offices and facilitate negotiations with a view to brokering and implementing peace agreements. The Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Great Lakes Region of Africa supported the implementation of the Peace, Security and Cooperation Framework for the Democratic Republic of the Congo and the Region, including through shuttle diplomacy and by providing support to the Regional Oversight Mechanism. The Special Envoy intensified engagements with regional and international stakeholders to prevent a regional spillover and maintain coherence and complementarity among the concurrent peace initiatives. Through sustained outreach, the Special Envoy helped to ensure that African-led efforts were consistent with ongoing efforts under the Washington and Doha processes. The Special Envoy of the Secretary-General

for Yemen engaged with a range of Yemeni stakeholders, with the aim of achieving de-escalation and maintaining the prospects for an inclusive, multitrack political process to end the conflict amid a significantly escalating situation. The Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Horn of Africa worked with regional leaders, Member States and partners to promote dialogue and advance preventive diplomacy and confidence-building amid regional tensions, including through the establishment of structured engagement platforms, such as the Friends of the Horn of Africa forum.

15. The various sanctions monitoring teams, groups and panels, the Ombudsperson and the Focal Point presented under thematic cluster II continued to provide substantive support to the Security Council in the implementation of its respective sanctions regimes. By Council resolution 2819 (2026), the mandate of the Panel of Experts on Libya was renewed until 15 August 2027. In its resolutions 2780 (2025) and 2804 (2025), the Council requested the Secretary-General to report on the implementation of the arms embargo on the high seas off the coast of Libya within five months of the adoption of the resolutions. The Secretary-General submitted his reports pursuant to those resolutions (S/2025/675 and S/2026/354, respectively). In addition, pursuant to resolution 2769 (2025), the Council authorized the frozen cash reserves of the Libyan Investment Authority to be invested in low-risk time deposits and in fixed financial instruments, subject to a notification and approval procedure by the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1970 (2011) concerning Libya, and requested the Panel of Experts to assess the effect and performance of those investments in their annual final reports. The Council also mandated the Panel of Experts on Yemen to present two additional reports: the first regarding dual-use components and precursor chemicals and their direct or indirect sale, supply or transfer to Yemen, and the second on ways to improve information-sharing and flag State capacity to prevent vessels suspected of violating resolution 2216 (2015) from entering Yemen. Pursuant to the process set forth in paragraphs 11 and 12 of Council resolution 2231 (2015), effective from 27 September 2025, all provisions of resolutions 1696 (2006), 1737 (2006), 1747 (2007), 1803 (2008), 1835 (2008) and 1929 (2010) were reapplied in the same manner as they applied before the adoption of resolution 2231 (2015) on 20 July 2015. Accordingly, the Panel of Experts on the Islamic Republic of Iran was reinstated by the Council, and its 2026 budget was approved by the General Assembly in its resolution 80/254.

16. The United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia has implemented the adjustments to the mandate approved by Security Council resolution 2798 (2025), focused on verifying the implementation of the provisions of the Final Agreement for Ending the Conflict and Building a Stable and Lasting Peace concerning comprehensive rural reform, and the reintegration of former combatants, as well as their security and that of communities in conflict-affected regions. The Mission accompanied the Government in the formulation of the rapid response plan adopted in October 2024 to accelerate the implementation of the Final Agreement, which includes the establishment of pacts between national and local authorities to accelerate the implementation of the development programmes with a territorial focus and to enhance their transformative potential in conflict-affected regions, as well as actions related to the comprehensive rural reform and security guarantees.

17. In Libya, in line with Libyan political road map, UNSMIL launched the structured dialogue with thematic groups on the economy, governance and security, as well as national reconciliation and human rights. Across the four tracks, the Mission supported a series of meetings aimed at developing concrete recommendations. UNSMIL has also facilitated meetings between the governance and economy tracks of the structured dialogue and the relevant Berlin process working groups in order for Libyans to convey first-hand their priorities and exchange views on international support needed to address critical reforms on strengthening governance.

18. In West Africa and the Sahel, UNOWAS led or supported several initiatives to prevent conflict, defuse election- and transition-related tensions, sustain peace and consolidate peacebuilding efforts. The Office continued efforts towards inclusive dialogue and open political processes and intensified its support for nationally owned dialogue processes, including through engagement with civil society, young people and women. It worked closely with regional and subregional organizations to strengthen peace and security in the region and to safeguard regional integration. The mission continued to solidify its existing partnerships in the area of maritime safety and security in the Gulf

of Guinea. In addition, the Office fostered cooperation between coastal States and Sahelian countries, enhancing collaborative efforts to counter the southward spread of terrorism and violent extremism conducive to terrorism.

19. In Haiti, BINUH developed the strategy requested through Security Council resolution 2743 (2024) in consultation with the Government of Haiti, improving international support for a Haitian-led, Haitian-owned formula to restore democratic institutions and fostering the participation of all sectors of Haitian society. The period saw the completion of the term of office of the Transitional Presidential Council and a peaceful handover of executive authority to the Council of Ministers on 7 February 2026. BINUH provided advice and guidance to the Haitian Provisional Electoral Council on the main challenges of the electoral process. BINUH continued to mentor and advise the Haitian National Police (and the Directorate of Penitentiary Administration) on critical policing matters, including anti-gang and anti-kidnapping operations, intelligence, election security, judicial police, criminal investigations, weapons and ammunition management, gender mainstreaming and gender equality, the legal framework, and police integrity and oversight. In January 2026, the mandate of BINUH was renewed by the Security Council under its resolution 2814 (2026), focusing on elections, disarmament, dismantlement and reintegration, and human rights, and on eliminating the mandate on police while maintaining the support of BINUH to the judiciary and helping to address prolonged pretrial detention, in addition to providing advisory support on the handling of high-risk individuals. In line with the provisions of paragraph 10 (e) of Council resolution 2793 (2025), UNSOH began to provide, on a cost-recovery basis, mission support services to BINUH in support of the delivery of its mandate.

20. In Afghanistan, UNAMA continued to support dialogue among Afghan stakeholders, the Mission and the international community on human rights, rule of law, governance and inclusion issues. Notwithstanding persistent restrictions on media freedoms, civic space and the enjoyment by Afghans of their human rights, most acutely affecting women, Afghans retained access to channels to express concerns and communicate priority needs, enabling their voices to inform discussions on the protection of human rights, including the rights of women and girls, and advocacy for a coherent socioeconomic, political and policy agenda. The Mission supported the counter-narcotics and private sector working groups under the Doha process and facilitated the high-level coordination forum and the technical level coordination forum with de facto ministries.

B. Operating environment and key policy issues

1. Women and peace and security

21. In line with the Secretary-General's continued commitment to advocating for a minimum of one third of women participants in mediation and peace processes, special political missions further advanced the full, equal and meaningful participation of women in those processes and strengthened gender-responsive conflict prevention, peacemaking and peacebuilding efforts. Gender advisers and gender focal points across special political missions continued to provide essential guidance to special representatives and envoys of the Secretary-General, ensuring that gender analysis and multidimensional risk assessments were systematically integrated into political strategies, good offices engagements and reporting.

22. Following the launch of the Common Pledge to Increase Women's Full, Equal and Meaningful Participation in Peace Processes on 24 October 2024, efforts to broaden its uptake accelerated. As of December 2025, 43 mediating entities, including Member States, regional organizations and other mediation actors, had adopted the Pledge, which was initiated, developed and supported by the Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs to galvanize collective action to overcome persistent barriers to women's participation. In the Sudan, the Office of the Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Sudan facilitated civil society consultations on the protection of civilians, including a dedicated session with women's groups, ensuring that women's perspectives informed conflict resolution efforts and the Personal Envoy's engagement with stakeholders.

23. The Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Great Lakes Region of Africa convened regular virtual coordination meetings with civil society organizations, women's groups and youth representatives in the Democratic Republic of the Congo and the wider Great Lakes region. These consultations provided timely gender-responsive analysis during the rapid escalation of Mouvement du 23 mars hostilities in North Kivu beginning in January 2025 and the subsequent advances in South Kivu. Insights from women and local actors were systematically incorporated into the Office's political, security and economic assessments, ensuring that local realities and gendered impacts directly informed reporting and recommendations.

24. The Mission of the Secretary-General's Good Offices in Cyprus continued to support women's organizations and women-led initiatives, bringing together women and bicommunal women's groups from across the island. Emphasizing the centrality of women's participation in peacemaking, the Office sustained facilitation of the Technical Committee on Gender Equality and advanced efforts to operationalize and further implement elements of the action plan to ensure women's full, equal and meaningful participation in the settlement process. In 2025, the membership of the technical committees reached gender parity, reflecting sustained advocacy and benchmarks established under the action plan. The Committee also co-developed, together with the Technical Committee on Environment, a project on climate change and women in science, technology, engineering and mathematics, examining and addressing the disproportionate impacts of climate change on women.

2. Youth and peace and security

25. In the context of growing geopolitical tensions and constrained resources, the youth and peace and security agenda remains an important framework across the United Nations system. During the reporting period, the Security Council held one meeting on youth and peace and security and subsequently adopted resolution 2807 (2025), reaffirming the positive role of young people, including young women, in conflict prevention, peacebuilding, sustaining peace and recovery, and emphasizing the importance of their full, effective and meaningful participation in peace and security efforts. The Council also recognized the significance of the world's youth population as a potential driver of stability and resilience while expressing concern that young people remain among those most adversely affected by armed conflict and instability.

26. Special political missions, uniquely positioned to advance the youth and peace and security agenda through their direct engagement with affected communities and established relationships with political actors and civil society organizations, continued to support youth participation in political and peace processes and to strengthen engagement with young women and men as agents of positive change. In March 2025, UNSMIL convened a workshop in Tripoli bringing together youth representatives and officials from the Ministries of Youth and Labour under its "YouEngage" strategy. Participants identified priorities for reducing community violence, including expanded vocational training, economic opportunities, psychosocial support and strengthened local governance. The United Nations Regional Centre for Preventive Diplomacy for Central Asia, through its Preventive Diplomacy Academy, continued to build the capacities of young leaders and support alumni-led community initiatives aimed at addressing drivers of tension and strengthening dialogue across communities in Central Asia and Afghanistan.

27. Special political missions also supported youth-led initiatives addressing structural drivers of conflict and promoting social cohesion. In Somalia, the Promoting Inclusive Action in Peacebuilding project in Marka district, supported by the Peacebuilding Fund, used the joint rehabilitation and management of irrigation canals as an entry point to address resource-related tensions between communities. Young people from different communities were trained as "peace agents" and played a leading role in establishing inclusive water governance committees. The initiative contributed to a significant reduction in disputes over water resources and strengthened cooperation among communities, demonstrating the important role that young people can play in advancing local conflict prevention and inclusive governance. In Afghanistan, amid continued restrictions on civic space, UNAMA conducted a series of youth consultations across the country in 2025 to facilitate engagement between Afghan young people and the United Nations. The consultations culminated in a youth round table

held on 25 September 2025 that brought together participants from all regions of the country and ensured gender-balanced participation, including of young women. Participants discussed issues affecting young people and shared perspectives on priorities and concerns regarding their future.

3. Electoral assistance

28. Special political missions continued to provide electoral assistance to Member States, where mandated or requested. In her capacity as the General Assembly-mandated focal point for electoral assistance, the Under-Secretary-General for Political and Peacebuilding Affairs receives requests aimed at supporting and strengthening the capacities of national electoral institutions. United Nations technical assistance and capacity-building were delivered in an integrated manner and, in many cases, alongside preventive diplomacy and conflict prevention efforts to foster consensus on electoral legal frameworks, promote inclusion and non-discrimination and encourage broad participation. Missions with electoral mandates continued to ensure that electoral assistance activities were guided by the principles of respect for sovereignty, national ownership and sustainability while promoting the participation of women, young people, persons with disabilities and other marginalized groups.

29. In Libya, municipal council elections spanned 2025 and continued into 2026. Pursuant to Security Council mandates, the United Nations is providing technical and advisory support to the High National Elections Commission through UNSMIL and the integrated United Nations electoral support team. This includes support for voter registration systems, operational preparedness and institutional capacity, as well as assistance to the United Nations-facilitated political road map and structured dialogue aimed at resolving legal, institutional and governance obstacles to credible presidential and legislative elections.

30. In Somalia, UNTMIS provided technical assistance to the newly established National Independent Electoral and Boundaries Commission, including legal, operational, logistical and training support. The Mission assisted the Commission in the electoral legal framework, planning, logistics, candidate nomination procedures, women's representation and ballot design. On 25 December 2025, the Commission conducted its first one-person, one-vote district elections in Banadir, Mogadishu, with technical support from UNTMIS. The Mission also delivered training sessions for civil society organization leaders in the federal member States on temporary special measures, electoral systems and electoral observation and continued to provide technical advice for forthcoming district, State and federal electoral processes.

31. In Iraq, on 11 November 2025, Iraq held its sixth parliamentary elections since 2005 with the support of UNAMI. The elections took place in a generally peaceful environment, with no major irregularities reported, reflecting the country's significant democratic progress. This marked the final electoral event supported by UNAMI. Over more than two decades, the Mission assisted in 17 electoral processes, including 6 federal legislative elections, provincial polls and elections in the Kurdistan Region. The support of UNAMI focused on strengthening the Independent High Electoral Commission, enhancing institutional capacity and procedures and promoting trust through dialogue, inclusion and transparency. In 2025, the Mission's electoral assistance continued to operate at the intersection of preventive diplomacy, technical advice, human rights, gender equality and development.

4. Safety and security

32. The majority of special political missions continue to operate in security environments characterized by their volatility and unpredictability, particularly within the context of highly complex local and regional events. Many missions deliver their mandates in areas of high-intensity military conflict or where the risks of terrorism, kinetic activity by armed groups, social unrest and high criminality require active mitigation, while in areas of relative stability, the situation may evolve to present serious safety and security threats.

33. In many locations, mission personnel, assets and premises remain at considerable risk from security threats, including through being in proximity to incidents in which the Organization is not the intended target. In Haiti, BINUH operates in an environment where gang violence and criminality

continue to affect international support to the country, while missions in Yemen again saw significant military activity in areas where they operate. Other missions across countries, including Afghanistan, Iraq, Somalia and the Syrian Arab Republic, also continued to face evolving security challenges related to their day-to-day activities and to the drawdown of their presence in some cases.

34. While host Governments bear primary responsibility for the security of mission personnel, some lack the capacity to provide adequate protection. Therefore, special political missions continued to adapt to local conditions, taking active measures to ensure the continued effective delivery of their mandates and fulfilment of their operational objectives. In support of this approach, missions have adopted robust security measures, guided by ongoing and systematic risk management processes. These are founded on a process of continuous risk assessment and adjustment of profile and presence, along with the implementation of proactive mitigation measures, including through deploying United Nations armed civilian security personnel, guard units and other security modalities, where necessary.

35. In all contexts, the Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs and the missions' leadership work closely with the Department of Safety and Security and other entities to review and refine risk management strategies, including mitigation measures, as needed, in order to minimize disruption to mandate implementation, including in support of the deployment of expert panels supporting Security Council committees.

C. Evaluation activities

36. The Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs continued to support evaluations and audits, including those conducted by external oversight bodies such as the Office of Internal Oversight Services (OIOS), the Joint Inspection Unit and the Board of Auditors, as well as its own internal evaluations. When relevant, key findings, recommendations and lessons learned from these evaluations were shared with special political missions to strengthen and inform their mandate implementation and have been factored into the programme plan for the upcoming period.

37. In 2025, OIOS completed an evaluation of conflict-specific special political missions under thematic cluster I to assess the relevance, effectiveness and coherence of their contributions to mitigating the risk of violent conflict. The evaluation concluded that the missions were uniquely positioned to convene stakeholders and facilitate dialogue, drawing on their perceived legitimacy, credibility and impartiality. Missions engaged a broad range of actors, including parties to conflict, geopolitical stakeholders, intergovernmental bodies and civil society, and employed diverse modalities to support political processes in complex and evolving contexts. The evaluation also found that missions effectively leveraged partnerships within the United Nations system and with external stakeholders to expand the scope and reach of their activities. At the same time, the evaluation identified areas for improvement, notably the need to strengthen strategic planning to better respond to evolving mandates and operating environments, enhance inclusivity to support broader social buy-in and the sustainability of peace processes, and improve inter-mission collaboration by making more systematic use of existing information-sharing mechanisms.

38. In 2025, the Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs provided support to the OIOS exercise on strengthening the role of evaluation and the application of evaluation findings on programme design, delivery and policy directives, as well as the evaluation of mandate implementation by UNAMA. Mission-specific evaluation activities are described, as applicable, under the specific missions in the three addenda to section 3, Political affairs (A/81/6 (Sect. 3)/Add.2, A/81/6 (Sect. 3)/Add.3 and A/81/6 (Sect. 3)/Add.4).

D. Lessons learned from the closure of missions and transition planning

39. The Department of Operational Support continues to systematically capture and apply lessons learned from mission closures and transitions to strengthen future planning and execution. Insights drawn from completed and ongoing closures are analysed and fed back into policy, guidance, and operational frameworks, ensuring that institutional knowledge is retained and applied consistently. The lessons directly inform practical guidance materials, including the Senior Mission Leadership Closure Guide, as well as associated standard operating procedures, tools, and checklists. They are also embedded in tailored training programmes and learning modules for senior leadership, planners and operational staff, helping to build capacity, mitigate risks and promote orderly, cost-effective and well-coordinated mission drawdowns across the Secretariat.

40. From 2025 to early in 2026, lessons learned from past mission transitions and closures were integrated into the planning processes of the liquidation of UNAMI, UNTMIS and UNMHA.

41. In Iraq, in line with Security Council resolution 2732 (2024) and the Secretary-General's transition and liquidation plan (S/2024/966), UNAMI continued to implement its mandate and drawdown during its final year. By 2 April 2026, UNAMI formally handed over its premises to the Government of Iraq following environmental remediation, asset verification and the repatriation of the United Nations Guard Unit. UNAMI will continue to conduct liquidation-related tasks remotely until 30 September 2026, after which all residual liquidation activities will be transferred to the Department of Operational Support.

42. To help to preserve gains and sustain peace, in cooperation with Iraqi counterparts, UNAMI worked with the United Nations country team and relevant agencies, funds and programmes on a set of thematic priorities that could continue to be advanced in the post-Mission phase. This included electoral assistance, as the Mission had worked in support of the Independent High Electoral Commission, which managed the smooth and effective conduct of the Council of Representatives election in November 2025.

43. To ensure uninterrupted security at the United Nations Integrated Compound in Baghdad, a new unarmed guard force recruited jointly by the Department of Safety and Security and the United Nations Development Programme assumed full-time access and internal control duties on 15 December 2025, replacing the guard unit personnel of UNAMI.

44. Drawing on lessons learned from past United Nations transitions, UNAMI made extensive efforts to support career transitions for staff separating from the Mission, including upskilling, reskilling and other professional development initiatives. Its training unit, in close collaboration with the Capacity Development and Operational Training Service within the Department of Operational Support, organized multiple training events and hosted four job fairs – one each in Baghdad, Erbil, Mosul and Kirkuk – with dozens of private sector employers, attracting more than 350 United Nations staff and personnel.

45. The United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework for Iraq for the period 2025–2029 was signed on 25 December 2025 by the Minister of Planning and the resident coordinator. In line with recommended practice, the framework incorporates residual tasks previously mandated to UNAMI, such as electoral assistance, human rights, women and peace and security, and climate security, and aligns with the national priorities of economic diversification, social protection, climate and water resilience, good governance and the rule of law.

46. In Somalia, the phased two-year transition of the United Nations presence, as outlined in Security Council resolution 2753 (2024), continued to progress during the reporting period. The handover of responsibilities under the first phase (which ended on 31 October 2025) has been completed. A road map for the second and final phase of the transition, jointly developed by the Federal Government of Somalia and the United Nations, was endorsed by the Council in its resolution 2809 (2025) and is under implementation. The drawdown of UNTMIS is scheduled to be completed by 31 October 2026.

47. Following the adoption of the road map for the second phase of the transition, the joint technical committee is meeting quarterly to monitor progress on all remaining UNTMIS tasks to be fully transitioned to the Federal Government, the country team and other stakeholders and to address challenges and ensure that the implementation of the road map remains on track for the conclusion of the UNTMIS mandate by 31 October 2026.

48. This work has informed the development of the United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework for Somalia for the period 2026–2030, which has been aligned to support the implementation of the country's national transformation plan. UNTMIS will support joint resource mobilization strategies of the Federal Government and the United Nations country team through the use of existing pooled funds such as the Somalia Joint Fund and the Peacebuilding Fund, as well as by reaching out to international financial institutions, other donors and the Somali private sector.

49. The Security Council, in its resolution 2786 (2025), requested a review of UNMHA with a view to delivering further efficiencies and structural coherence and coordination across United Nations missions in Yemen. After the arbitrary detention of dozens of United Nations national personnel (73 since 2021), the Organization had to significantly narrow the operating environment for staff across Houthi-controlled areas as a mitigating measure to ensure staff safety and security. In response to heightened security risks in Houthi-controlled areas, in October 2025, UNMHA international staff temporarily relocated from those areas to government-controlled areas, along with other United Nations international staff.

50. In its resolution 2813 (2026), the Security Council extended the mandate of UNMHA for a final two-month period, until 31 March, and requested that the Mission's residual tasks be transferred to the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen. In February 2026, UNMHA and the Office jointly developed a transition plan and initiated the gradual handover of the Mission's core residual tasks to the Office. A joint delegation from UNMHA and the Office met members of the Redeployment Coordination Committee in Hudaydah. Discussions focused on joint achievements by the Committee, residual tasks, and arrangements for transition to the Office. UNMHA and the Office reiterated the commitment of the United Nations to continue to support the implementation of the Agreement on the City of Hudaydah and the Ports of Hudaydah, Salif and Ra's Isa and the importance of sustained communication and cooperation in support of stability in Hudaydah and Yemen. The delegation also met Houthi de facto authorities in Sana'a, further developing the necessary transition arrangements and preparing for the next phase of their partnership. UNMHA has also engaged with the United Nations country team, local authorities and other key actors to ensure a smooth handover to the Office.

III. Operational effectiveness and responsible stewardship

A. Integration of services in the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe, Uganda

51. Established in July 2010, RSCE provides administrative, financial, procurement, logistical, and information and communications technology (ICT) services to peacekeeping operations, special political missions and other client entities. The Centre also provides residual administrative and liquidation support to closed and liquidating missions, thereby safeguarding the Organization's fiduciary responsibilities beyond mandate closure. Through the application of standardized processes, economies of scale and strengthened internal controls, the Centre enables client entities to discharge their mandates while promoting efficiency, accountability and continuity of operations.

52. In 2026, in line with the recommendation of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions as endorsed by the General Assembly in its resolution 78/294,[3] RSCE adopted a phased, risk-based approach to assume responsibility for the provision of services to current client entities[4] previously supported by the Kuwait Joint Support Office. The full operational integration of these clients into RSCE service delivery arrangements will take effect on 1 July 2026, concurrent with the operational closure of the Office. The transition was coordinated under the leadership of the Department of Operational Support and guided by dedicated governance and transition management arrangements, with a view to ensuring operational readiness, service continuity and an orderly transfer of responsibilities. The Secretariat considers this integration to be a significant milestone in its efforts to strengthen, standardize and consolidate shared service delivery, in line with the Secretary-General's reform agenda and the requests from the Assembly on centralized support functions.

53. As of 1 July 2026, RSCE will support 33 active client entities with combined annual budgets of approximately $4.3 billion. The transfer of Kuwait Joint Support Office clients will result in an increase in the number of active clients receiving full services.[5] This level of service activities underscores the Centre's critical role in enabling the effective and compliant implementation of mandates financed under both peacekeeping and regular budget resources.

54. In addition to supporting active mandates, RSCE continues to perform residual liquidation functions for previous client missions whose mandates expired in previous periods, including the United Nations Integrated Transition Assistance Mission in the Sudan (UNITAMS), and the United Nations Integrated Peacebuilding Office in Guinea-Bissau (UNIOGBIS), where certain administrative support processes remain. The Centre is also assuming responsibility for residual liquidation support for the United Nations Investigative Team to Promote Accountability for Crimes Committed by Da'esh/Islamic State in Iraq and the Levant (UNITAD), UNAMI and UNMHA, all of which made the transition from the Kuwait Joint Support Office to the Centre.

55. The proposed budget for RSCE for the 2026/27 period (see A/80/611) is under consideration by the General Assembly at the second part of its resumed eightieth session. In that budget, resources in the amount of $45,155,400 are proposed by the Secretary-General for the maintenance of the Centre for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027, to be apportioned on a pro rata basis among the budgets of the Centre's active client peacekeeping operations, as well as special political missions financed under section 3, Political affairs, of the regular budget. The Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions recommended that the proposed resources be increased by

[3] In that resolution, the General Assembly endorsed the recommendation of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions in its report (A/78/744/Add.6, para. 12) that, "in view of the evolving landscape of peacekeeping operations, the Advisory Committee emphasizes the need to review the role of the Regional Service Centre within the comprehensive context of the global support architecture, with a view to potentially providing additional services to other entities, as well as developing broader cooperation with regional organizations, such as the African Union".

[4] United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon, United Nations Disengagement Observer Force, United Nations Logistics Base at Brindisi, Italy, United Nations Interim Administration Mission in Kosovo, United Nations Peacekeeping Force in Cyprus, United Nations Truce Supervision Organization (UNTSO), United Nations Military Observer Group in India and Pakistan, Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for the Middle East Peace Process, Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Syria, Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen, United Nations Regional Centre for Preventive Diplomacy for Central Asia, Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon, United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia, United Nations Integrated Office in Haiti and United Nations Assistance Mission in Afghanistan.

[5] The Regional Service Centre in Entebbe, Uganda, will provide core services to the United Nations Assistance Mission in Afghanistan, the United Nations Regional Centre for Preventive Diplomacy for Central Asia, the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen, the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Syria and the United Nations Integrated Office in Haiti, as well as the United Nations Interim Administration Mission in Kosovo and the United Nations Peacekeeping Force in Cyprus, which were receiving non-core services under the Kuwait Joint Support Office. The United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon, the United Nations Disengagement Observer Force, UNTSO, the United Nations Military Observer Group in India and Pakistan, the Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for the Middle East Peace Process, the Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon, the United Nations Verification Mision in Colombia and the United Nations Logistics Base will receive non-core services effective 1 July 2026.

$756,200, from $45,155,400 to $45,911,600, for the maintenance of the Centre for the 12-month period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 (A/80/604/Add.4, para. 56). To this end, an amount of $3.3 million has been included in the proposed programme budget for 2027, representing the share of special political missions.[6] This provision will be subject to a final adjustment to be made in accordance with the decision to be taken by the Assembly in the context of the budget of the Centre for the 2026/27 period, which is expected by the end of June 2026.

56. With regard to the observation of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions that the provision of a full suite of services to clients previously receiving limited services should be reviewed for possible streamlining (A/80/7/Add.10, para. 56), the Secretariat underscores that RSCE is fully positioned to provide the complete range of non-location-dependent services to all former Kuwait Joint Support Office clients.

B. Alignment of human resources and capabilities with operational requirements

57. Within the broader context of the UN80 Initiative, improving efficiency, realigning functions and optimizing the way that the United Nations works are core considerations when undertaking workforce planning. In terms of delivering on these expectations, having strategic workforce capabilities continues to be reinforced throughout the Organization. For example, the key capabilities for a United Nations 2.0, including data expertise, innovation capacity, digital dexterity and strategic foresight, and leveraging behavioural science are priorities, along with strengthening capabilities in strategic communications. New generic job profiles covering these capabilities have been developed or are under development.

58. Proposals for the reclassification and reassignment of existing functions in missions using these new profiles, especially when leveraging opportunities from upcoming retirements to create more junior-level posts to rejuvenate the workforce, are vital elements in advancing a workforce transformation. Specific attention is also paid to reducing the number of high-level posts (D-1 and above) with the proposed budget for 2027, comprising the abolishment of one Under-Secretary-General post in support to the implementation of Security Council resolution 1559 (2004), one D-1 post in the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia and one D-1 post in BINUH, and the downward reclassification of one D-1 post to the P-5 level in the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Syria.

59. Efforts continue to ensure that human resources policies are responsive to the needs of entities with a field presence. Specifically, the Office of Human Resources develops and revises administrative issuances, streamlines policies and procedures to respond to the needs of field entities and provides authoritative policy interpretation and advice on all human resources policies applicable to field entities, including in emergency and crisis situations, as well as during downsizing and reduction-of-staff exercises. The Office remains actively engaged in the work of the Human Resources Network Standing Committee on Field Duty Stations and the tripartite Working Group for the Review of Conditions of Life and Work in Field Duty Stations of the International Civil Service Commission (ICSC), which monitor matters related to the conditions of service of staff in the field, including rest and recuperation, danger pay, hardship classification and non-family designation of duty stations. As part of the Office's participation in ICSC discussions, ongoing reviews are carried out for key field entitlements, including hardship allowance, non-family service allowance, mobility incentive, relocation package, danger pay and security evacuation allowance, as well as the methodology for setting post adjustment in field duty stations. The Office is actively engaged in the comprehensive review of the United Nations common system compensation package being conducted by ICSC pursuant to General Assembly resolution 77/256 B, which includes a full review of the

[6] Excluding UNTSO, the United Nations Military Observer Group in India and Pakistan and the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization, which are funded under the programme budget. Their respective share of the Regional Service Centre for 2027 is presented in the proposed programme budget for these three entities (A/81/6 (Sect. 5) and A/81/6 (Sect. 3), respectively).

compensation package for staff in field locations. The Office also conducts periodic salary surveys to establish and update salary scales for staff in locally recruited categories in field duty stations.

1. Promoting national capacities

60. Encouraging the use of national capacities has been a core area of focus in human resources management in special political missions. In line with the request of the General Assembly in its resolutions 61/276 and 66/264 for greater utilization of national staff, and through the guidance provided in the workforce planning nationalization guide[7] issued in December 2021, special political missions reviewed their staffing requirements prior to the submission of the budget to determine the feasibility of nationalization, commensurate with the requirements of the missions and their mandates.

61. According to the workforce planning nationalization guide, when identifying opportunities for nationalization, special political missions use the following criteria: (a) identification of vacant international posts and positions, including United Nations Volunteer positions, which could be considered for conversion to national posts or positions; (b) in the case of any changes in mandate, determination of whether the function remains necessary to meet the objectives of the mission and maintain the international character of the operation; (c) assessment of whether there might be a perception of conflict of interest for the function; (d) determination of whether the function requires regular movement across international borders or lines of conflict; (e) determination of whether the function has security-related requirements that prohibit specific categories of staff; and (f) determination of the availability of talent in the local labour market, including the required knowledge and skills. The rate of nationalization is therefore dynamic and can be affected if there is a lack of qualifications in the local labour market, which tends to occur in conflict-affected areas where the local education system and pool of qualified candidates may have been disrupted.

62. The conditions and criteria for nationalization outlined above are further assessed against each mission's operational context. Missions were encouraged to ensure that national staff were empowered and skilled to carry out the implementation of the mandate while ensuring that the international character of the mission was maintained.

63. Special political missions continued to make steady progress in the nationalization of posts.[8] For 2027, it is proposed that two posts be nationalized in the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia and one post in UNSMIL. In addition, it is proposed that eight additional national posts (6 National Professional Officer and 2 Local level) be established in UNSMIL, reflecting the Mission's efforts towards the promotion of national capacity for the delivery of its critical mandated activities, and that one Local level post be established in the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia, as indicated in table 1.

[7] In December 2021, the Department of Operational Support issued a guide on planning nationalization of the workforce. The guide provides practical information for conducting nationalization in the context of operational workforce planning at the entity level and is aimed at setting consistent standards and approaches on nationalization across entities.

[8] A total of 12 posts were nationalized in 2016, 1 in 2017, 2 in 2018, 5 in 2019, 7 in 2020, 4 in 2021, 19 in 2022, 9 in 2023, 5 in 2024, 7 in 2025 and 15 in 2026.

Note: The following abbreviations are used in tables: ASG, Assistant Secretary-General; FS, Field Service; GS, General Service; GTA, general temporary assistance; LL, Local level; NPO, National Professional Officer; OL, Other level; PL, Principal level; UNV, United Nations Volunteers; USG, Under-Secretary-General.

Table 1
Proposed nationalization of functions and additional national posts, 2027

Mission	*Number*	*Original functional title of post*	*Proposed functional title of post*
UNSMIL	1	Security Sector Reform Officer (P-3)	Associate Security Sector Reform Officer (NPO)
UNSMIL	1	–	Economic Affairs Officer (NPO)
UNSMIL	1	–	Associate Security Sector Reform Officer (NPO)
UNSMIL	2	–	Associate Public Information Officer (NPO)
UNSMIL	1	–	Associate Human Rights Officer (NPO)
UNSMIL	1	–	Medical Officer (NPO)
UNSMIL	1	–	Supply Assistant (LL)
UNSMIL	1	–	Information Technology Assistant (LL)
United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia	1	Administrative Officer (P-3)	Administrative Officer (NPO)
United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia	1	Associate Training Officer (P-2)	Associate Training Officer (NPO)
United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia	1	–	Administrative Assistant (LL) (new)

2. Gender parity and geographical representation

64. The United Nations is advancing efforts to achieving gender parity, guided by the principles of merit and fairness in all selection processes. Efforts are ongoing, with a focus on strengthening recruitment, particularly through proactive outreach, among other efforts. While financial constraints continue to cause temporary hiring restrictions, the Organization remains committed to pursuing existing efforts and expanding targeted engagement, especially for field-based roles in special political missions. Outreach strategies are being refined to maintain momentum and ensure a steady pipeline of diverse talent.

65. Improving living and working conditions in field duty stations remains a critical priority for the recruitment and retention of women and continues to be advanced through more targeted and practical interventions. Efforts are focused on strengthening the implementation of the Field-specific Enabling Environment Guidelines for the United Nations System, including by strengthening more consistent implementation across duty stations and promoting measurable improvement in safety, flexibility and inclusive workplace practices. Specific attention is being given to reinforcing organizational culture and leadership accountability, informed by the results of the 2024 staff engagement survey, to address persistent gaps in workplace experience across field settings. At the same time, dedicated efforts are under way to strengthen workforce resilience, including through enhanced support for the mental health and well-being of all staff, preventive psychosocial measures and the expansion of tools and guidance for managers to better support staff serving in hardship duty stations, who face heightened stressors and operational challenges.

66. The Secretariat remains committed to accelerating progress towards equitable geographical distribution in posts subject to geographical distribution and to promoting as wide a geographical basis as possible in the recruitment of staff for non-geographical posts, including those in special political missions and peacekeeping operations. Achieving equitable geographical distribution and greater geographical representation requires sustained and deliberate action, particularly in the light of low applicant volumes from unrepresented and underrepresented Member States, systemic challenges and legacy recruitment patterns.

67. As highlighted in the report of the Secretary-General on the implementation of human resources management reforms: outlook for 2026–2029 (A/80/550), structural issues in the staff selection system continue to hinder faster progress towards achieving the equitable geographical distribution goal. In response, the Secretariat is advancing reforms to strengthen its staff selection framework.

The implementation of the Staff Selection 2.0 initiative is progressing, aimed at enhancing the efficiency, transparency and consistency of recruitment processes and supporting more objective and skills-based selection decisions. Concurrently, the Secretariat has recalibrated its talent attraction approaches, including through the development of purposeful partnerships with Member States, universities and professional networks, with a focus on expanding outreach and translating such efforts into sustained improvements in geographical representation. The efforts are aimed at positioning the United Nations as an employer of choice and at cultivating diverse talent pipelines to meet both current and future workforce needs. This forward-looking approach is designed to ensure a continuous flow of qualified candidates and to strengthen workforce readiness. While substantive change will require time, benefits from this approach are already anticipated in the short to medium term. The Secretariat underscores the importance of adequate resources to sustain and scale talent outreach initiatives. Additional investments would enhance the Secretariat's capacity to engage meaningfully with Member States and to implement outreach activities in support of equitable geographical distribution.

3. Recruitment panels for generic job openings

68. Recruitment from global rosters remains a critical enabler for timely and high-quality staffing of civilian positions in special political missions. Under the new staff selection system policy promulgated through administrative instruction ST/AI/2025/2, the building and management of rosters are reinforced as the Secretariat's primary mechanism for ensuring that qualified, gender-balanced, geographically diverse and multilingual personnel are readily available for rapid deployment to support mission mandates. Expert panels, which play a central role in the establishment and maintenance of global rosters for international recruited positions, are normally composed of at least three members, including two subject matter experts at the same or higher level of the job opening, at least one woman and one member from outside the originating work unit. This composition enhances impartiality, consistency and the overall integrity of the assessment process. Expert panels, which mirror the composition of assessment panels, will continue to convene in 2027 to assess and recommend candidates applying to generic job openings in support of the roster-based recruitment by field missions. By centralizing the assessment function, the panels reduce the administrative burden on individual hiring managers while supporting the Human Resources Services Division of the Department of Operational Support in conducting high-quality and standardized evaluations. Roster selections continue to demonstrate their operational value as a fast-track recruitment modality: in 2025, 70 per cent of selections for international positions (Field Service level 4 to D-1) in field missions (special political missions and peacekeeping operations) were from rosters, compared with 37 per cent in the global Secretariat.

69. In 2027, through its Human Resources Services Division and in collaboration with roster-building partners across the Secretariat, the Department of Operational Support will continue to manage generic job openings across networks to ensure that the global rosters remain current, diverse and responsive to projected civilian staffing demands in special political missions. These efforts are further supported by enhanced assessment modalities, continued improvements in the Secretariat's recruitment platform and strengthened data-driven operational workforce planning methodologies to reinforce the timely deployment of high-quality personnel in support of evolving mission mandates.

4. Strengthening coherence and collaboration between pillars in special political missions

70. Depending on the context of the country and mission, the Deputy Special Representatives of the Secretary-General may have triple functions to perform, also serving as resident coordinators and humanitarian coordinators. Five special political missions, namely, UNTMIS, the Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon, UNSMIL, BINUH and UNAMA, include Deputy Special Representatives of the Secretary-General, or Deputy Special Coordinators, who have the triple functions and serve also as resident coordinators and humanitarian coordinators in complex, multidimensional contexts. These deputies constitute the link between the political work of the special political mission and the United Nations entities implementing development and humanitarian activities in coordination with the mission. As Resident Coordinator, the incumbent is

responsible for coordinating operations and activities relating to the United Nations country team and United Nations development activities, for ensuring that the activities of the United Nations country team are aligned with national priorities, as captured in United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Frameworks, for providing oversight and transparency on joint activities of the United Nations country team and for mobilizing partnerships and financing in support of country efforts towards the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals. The office of the resident coordinator supports those functions. As Humanitarian Coordinator, the incumbent is responsible for coordinating humanitarian plans and operations and for maintaining links with Governments and other parties, donors and the broader humanitarian community. The salaries and common staff costs related to the posts of Deputy Special Representative of the Secretary-General, Resident Coordinator and Humanitarian Coordinator are budgeted at 50 per cent of the total cost in the 2027 budgets of the special political missions, pursuant to General Assembly resolutions 59/296 and 72/279, with the other 50 per cent funded through the Development Coordination Office. In line with Security Council resolution 2594 (2021), the Secretariat continues to strengthen coherence and collaboration between the respective pillars in mission settings.

71. Appropriately sized and dedicated capacity in the mission structure is required to support the Deputy Special Representatives, Resident Coordinators and Humanitarian Coordinators in carrying out their cross-pillar function within the mission and to provide sufficient support for their role in coordinating the work of the various units reporting to them. Where needed, the Secretariat will apply the two criteria of its policy in ascertaining the level of support capacity for the Deputy Special Representatives of the Secretary-General, Resident Coordinators and Humanitarian Coordinators: (a) the number of units reporting to them; and (b) the number of substantive mandate points assigned to the office (A/79/6 (Sect. 3)/Add.1, para. 79).

C. Continued efforts to improve operational effectiveness

1. Air operations

72. The Secretariat has taken measures to seek efficiencies and enhance the utilization of air fleets, with guidance provided to inform staff in field missions with the requisite technical and operational oversight. The portfolio of standby air solutions, which include charter agreements, air ambulance services, aircraft services under letters of assist and other short-term agreements, is aimed at increasing the Secretariat's agility and responsiveness in logistics by addressing, among other things, urgent requests for ad hoc requirements, and at providing improved, efficient and timely support.

73. In 2026, total resources approved for air operations for the 36 special political missions amount to $27.6 million, with the planned utilization of approximately 2,903 flight hours (2,203 for fixed-wing aircraft and 700 for rotary-wing aircraft). For 2027, resources in the amount of $22.4 million are proposed for a total of 2,016 flight hours (1,406 for fixed-wing aircraft and 610 for rotary-wing aircraft). This represents a decrease of $5.1 million, or 18.6 per cent, in proposed resources, and a reduction of 887 flight hours, or 30.6 per cent, compared with 2026. Six missions (Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen, UNOWAS, UNSMIL, the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia, BINUH and UNAMA) account for 99.4 per cent of the total projected air operations requirements for 2027. The decrease in requirement is the result of: (a) the downsizing of the aviation fleet in the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia through the discontinuation of the rental and operations of the fixed-wing aircraft and the reduction of one rotary-wing aircraft, owing to operational adjustments and the optimization of fleet utilization; (b) reduced requirements in UNSMIL and UNAMA due to a decrease in flight hours in line with historical utilization rates; and (c) a review of the air operations arrangements of BINUH following the deployment of UNSOH and the arrangement with UNSOH to utilize its air capabilities on a cost-recovery basis in BINUH. The decrease is offset in part by increased requirements for the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen reflecting a full-year provision in 2027, compared with nine months in 2026, following the transfer of UNMHA air operations contracts to the Office of the Special Envoy effective from 1 April 2026.

2. Travel

74. The total resources proposed for official travel amount to $9.8 million, reflecting a decrease of $56,100, or 0.6 per cent, compared with the approved budget for 2026. While the reduction is modest, this reflects a level carefully considered after multiple years of reductions to resources under official travel.[9] The travel plans are based on the principle that official travel will be undertaken only where it cannot be substituted by other means of communication, including videoconferencing. For the sanctions monitoring teams, groups and panels, the proposed budget for official travel of staff for 2027 takes into account the frequency of travel by the Chairs of relevant sanctions committees to countries and regions relevant to their relevant sanctions regime, which requires support from Secretariat staff. The proposed budget for all sanctions expert groups or panels not based in New York provides for one trip by one Secretariat staff member to the relevant region to assist the Chair and/or the group or panel, as well as two trips by one staff member to assist the group or panel during the drafting of interim or midterm and final reports. In addition, the proposed budget for three of the groups or panels that are not based in New York includes one more trip by two Secretariat staff to a country relevant to the sanctions regime to conduct Security Council-mandated sanctions assessment missions.

75. The programme plans of the special political missions, as presented in the proposed programme budget under the thematic clusters, provide further information, when applicable, on how special political missions have incorporated good practices into and increased the use of technology in their work, while also reflecting on the challenges experienced where technology meets its limits and in-person travel is needed to meet demand and fill coverage gaps. Travel to provide good offices and mediation, conduct fact-finding, investigation and monitoring activities, and verify compliance and conduct outreach, as well as provide training or capacity-building to national and local partners, remains an indispensable tool in carrying out the work of the special political missions in 2027.

76. With respect to the performance of special political missions against the 16-day advance purchase policy, the Secretariat is following the observations and recommendations of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions with respect to the need to put measures in place to enhance performance. The overall performance of all special political missions improved from 39 per cent in 2024 to 50 per cent in 2025, maintaining a sustained positive trend since 2019 (18 per cent). In 2025, of a total of 37 missions, 3 achieved 100 per cent compliance, and 22 showed improved performance compared with 2024. This improvement reflected efforts across the Secretariat, including regular reminders to missions of their responsibility to monitor real-time performance against the advance purchase policy using corporate dashboards and to investigate performance drivers and solutions. As noted in the most recent report of the Secretary-General on standards of accommodation for air travel (A/79/628), key performance drivers across the Secretariat are late submission of travel requests; travel requests that were not “right the first time” and required rework, adding to the processing time; travel by “external” travellers such as meeting participants and external experts over whom the Secretariat has less administrative control; and circumstances outside the entities’ control such as travel document delays or operational issues, including emergencies or exigencies of service. Actions that entities have taken to improve performance include preparing and monitoring quarterly travel plans, escalating late travel requests to senior leadership within the entity, and regularly communicating to staff the process to comply with the policy.

3. Mine action activities

77. In 2025, the Mine Action Service continued to support special political missions with a mine action component by assisting in planning, programme design, implementation, reporting and representation.

[9] Legislative reductions under official travel against the Secretary-General’s budget proposals were as follows: 0.9 per cent in 2020, 17.9 per cent in 2021, 9.8 per cent in 2022, 5.6 per cent in 2023, 4.1 per cent in 2024, 3.4 per cent in 2025 and 4.6 per cent in 2026.

78. In the field, mine action efforts contributed to mandate delivery primarily through the provision of technical advice and expertise to mission leadership and relevant national counterparts. Specifically, in UNAMA, the mine action component provided explosive ordnance threat assessments, and advised and coordinated mitigation measures in support of humanitarian and development initiatives, including support to the Mine Action Technical Cell, which leads nationwide coordination, quality assurance and management of data on hazardous area to keep the United Nations, partners and the public informed of the explosive threat. In accordance with its mandate as contained in Security Council resolution 2626 (2022) and reaffirmed in subsequent resolutions, UNAMA supports existing mechanisms to improve the overall security situation in Afghanistan, provide assessments of the explosive ordnance threat and its impact on civilians, including children, advise and coordinate explosive ordnance threat mitigation measures in support of humanitarian and development initiatives, and support the coordination of the humanitarian mine action sector. Given that the current mine action capacity of UNAMA is insufficient to undertake mine action coordination at the national level, the ability of UNAMA to implement its mine action mandate depends on a functioning Technical Cell. Amid declining funding for the sector alongside a growing reliance on the coordination and data function, UNAMA plans to provide direct support to sustain the Technical Cell core functions in 2027.

79. In UNSMIL, efforts focused on capacity-building of the Libyan Mine Action Centre and relevant national security institutions in explosive ordnance clearance and weapons and ammunition management. Mine action also supported ceasefire implementation through engagement with the 5+5 Joint Military Commission and military demining teams from both the west and east.

80. In UNMHA, prior to 2025, efforts centred on technical guidance to improve coordination among local authorities and with international partners. Following the Mission's closure pursuant to Security Council resolution 2813 (2026), technical guidance on mine action and coordination support in Yemen will continue under the auspices of Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen.

4. Ratios for vehicles and information technology equipment

81. In its resolution 80/243, the General Assembly endorsed the recommendation of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions for special political missions to limit, to the extent possible, the acquisition of new vehicles and laptops pending a review of the composition of their ground fleets and laptop holdings in the context of reduced operational footprints (A/80/7/Add.10, para. 65). The missions continue to monitor excess holdings of vehicles and plan to dispose of vehicles once they meet established criteria, including life expectancy or write-off thresholds, or to recommend their transfer to other missions, where feasible and cost-effective.

82. In the above context, the holdings of vehicles and information technology equipment are proposed on the basis of the anticipated personnel incumbency levels planned for 2027, as opposed to the full authorized level of personnel. Table 2 provides the ratios for vehicles for all special political missions that have vehicle holdings, while table 3 provides the ratios for information technology equipment for all special political missions.

Table 2
Proposed allocation of light vehicles for 2027

	2027 proposed personnel[a]	*Personnel adjusted for vacancy rate*[a]	*Standard allocation*[b,c]	*2027 proposed holdings (budget)*[b,c]	*Variance (percentage)*
Cluster I					
Mission of the Secretary-General's Good Offices in Cyprus	9	8	3	3	–
Office of the United Nations Representative to the Geneva International Discussions	3	2	1	2	100.0
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Syria	31	28	13	7	(46.2)
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Great Lakes Region	18	15	6	6	–
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Horn of Africa	7	7	4	4	–
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen	64	56	18	19	5.6
Subtotal	**132**	**116**	**45**	**41**	**(8.9)**
Cluster II					
Panel of Experts pursuant to resolution 2713 (2023)	1	1	2[d]	2	–
Subtotal	**1**	**1**	**2**	**2**	**–**
Cluster III					
UNOWAS	57	52	15	13	(13.3)
United Nations Regional Centre for Preventive Diplomacy for Central Asia	10	10	4	1	(75.0)
United Nations support for the Cameroon-Nigeria Mixed Commission	7	6	3	8	166.7
Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon	19	18	10	11	10.0
UNOCA	29	28	10	11	10.0
UNSMIL	252	226	65	54	(16.9)
United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia	516	454	107	130	21.5
BINUH	103	97	25	44	76.0
UNAMA	359	317	76	131	72.4
Subtotal	**1 352**	**1 208**	**315**	**403**	**27.9**
Total	**1 485**	**1 325**	**362**	**446**	**23.2**

[a] Includes United Nations international staff, NPOs, international UNV, military and police personnel (military observers, military police and civilian police officers), government-provided personnel and contractors.
[b] Includes armoured vehicles, except those earmarked or required for the exclusive use of close protection and some security tasks. Excludes guard-forces-carrying and utility vehicles, buses and electric carts.
[c] Based on standard equipment as outlined in the Standard Cost and Ratio Manual issued by the Department of Operational Support.
[d] Takes into account requirements for the five experts.

83. The total proposed vehicle holdings for special political missions are 23.2 per cent higher than the standard allocation based on the Standard Cost and Ratio Manual. Provisions of new or replacement vehicles to missions take into consideration the operational circumstances, including the terrain and infrastructure in the area of operations, security considerations and the supply and availability of spare parts. Explanations for vehicle holdings that are higher than the standard allocation in specific missions are as follows:

(a) The vehicle holdings for the office of the United Nations Representative to the Geneva International Discussions are 100 per cent, or one vehicle, higher than the standard allocation and reflect the operational needs in both Tbilisi and Zugdidi, Georgia;

(b) The vehicle holdings for the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen are 5.6 per cent, or one vehicle, higher than the standard allocation and reflect operational needs;

(c) The vehicle holdings for United Nations support for the Cameroon-Nigeria Mixed Commission are higher than the standard allocation by 166.7 per cent, or five vehicles, which reflects the need for dedicated transportation to support the movement of the joint technical teams and their security personnel along with all their logistics equipment while in the field. The presence of these vehicles allows for flexibility and the ability to move freely within the areas of operations, many of which are isolated and hard to reach and have limited infrastructure and unsafe conditions;

(d) The vehicle holdings for the Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon are higher than the standard allocation by 10.0 per cent, or one vehicle, and reflect the operational need to support official meetings and engagement across Lebanon;

(e) The vehicle holdings for UNOCA are higher than the standard allocation by 10.0 per cent, or one vehicle, and reflect operational needs;

(f) The vehicle holdings for the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia are 21.5 per cent higher than the standard allocation, which is attributable to an operational requirement for national Local level staff[10] to utilize mission vehicles in a manner comparable to National Professional Officers and military observers to perform official duties, attend field activities and support mandate implementation;

(g) The vehicle holdings for BINUH are 76.0 per cent higher than the standard allocation, which is attributable to: (i) the need for mission personnel to self-drive to and from residences within the green zone following the transfer of mission support functions to UNSOH; and (ii) the need for frequent maintenance and repair caused by poor road conditions and the extensive time needed for repairs at outsourced workshops;

(h) The vehicle holdings for UNAMA are 72.4 per cent higher than the standard allocation, which is attributable to: (i) the operational requirement for a pool of vehicles for Kabul to provide dispatch transportation for all staff in the Mission; (ii) the provision of airport shuttle services; and (iii) vehicles to conduct driver testing. Nevertheless, UNAMA is reviewing the holdings with the aim of achieving better alignment with the standard ratio, in consideration of its security and operational needs.

[10] The standard ratio for vehicles ratio does not take into account the need for vehicles for national General Service and Local level staff.

Table 3
Proposed allocation of computing devices for 2027

			Computing devices[a]			
	2027 proposed personnel[b]	*Personnel adjusted for vacancy rate*[b]	*Standard allocation*[c]	*Standard allocation and spares*	*2027 proposed holdings (budget)*	*Variance (percentage)*
Cluster I						
Mission of the Secretary-General's Good Offices in Cyprus	13	12	12	14	14	–
Office of the Special Adviser to the Secretary-General on the Prevention of Genocide	14	12	12	14	14	–
Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for Western Sahara	2	2	2	2	2	–
Office of the United Nations Representative to the Geneva International Discussions	4	3	3	4	4	–
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Syria	65	62	62	71	80	12.7
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Horn of Africa	7	7	7	11	11	–
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Great Lakes Region	30	27	27	49	33	(32.7)
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen	130	117	117	142	160	12.7
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General on Myanmar	5	5	5	5	5	–
Office of the Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Sudan	7	5	5	7	7	–
Senior Representative for the implementation of Security Council resolution 2792 (2025)	2	2	2	2	2	–
Subtotal	**281**	**256**	**256**	**323**	**334**	**3.4**
Cluster II						
Group of Experts on the Democratic Republic of the Congo	1	1	1	1	1	–
Panel of Experts on the Sudan	1	1	1	1	1	–
Support to the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1718 (2006)	2	2	2	2	2	–
Panel of Experts on Libya	2	2	2	2	2	–
Panel of Experts pursuant to resolution 2745 (2024)	2	2	2	2	2	–
Panel of Experts on Yemen	4	4	4	4	4	–
Panel of Experts on South Sudan	3	3	3	3	3	–
Analytical Support and Sanctions Monitoring Team pursuant to Security Council resolutions 1526 (2004) and 2253 (2015) concerning Islamic State in Iraq and the Levant (Da'esh), Al-Qaida and the Taliban and associated individuals and entities	24	21	21	24	24	–
Office of the Ombudsperson established pursuant to Security Council resolution 1904 (2009)	2	2	2	2	2	–
Panel of Experts pursuant to resolution 2713 (2023)	9	9	9	9	9	–
Panel of Experts on Haiti	3	3	3	3	3	–
Office of the Focal Point for Delisting	3	2	2	3	3	–
Panel of Experts on the Islamic Republic of Iran	3	2	2	2	2	–
Support to the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1540 (2004) on the non-proliferation of all weapons of mass destruction	14	14	14	15	15	–
Counter-Terrorism Committee Executive Directorate	48	43	43	48	48	–
Subtotal	**121**	**111**	**113**	**121**	**121**	**–**

			Computing devices[a]			
	2027 proposed personnel[b]	*Personnel adjusted for vacancy rate*[b]	*Standard allocation*[c]	*Standard allocation and spares*	*2027 proposed holdings (budget)*	*Variance (percentage)*
Cluster III						
UNOWAS	77	71	71	76	87	14.5
United Nations Regional Centre for Preventive Diplomacy for Central Asia	26	26	26	26	25	(3.8)
United Nations support for the Cameroon-Nigeria Mixed Commission	15	14	14	17	19	11.8
Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon	72	70	70	72	72	–
UNOCA	42	35	35	54	56	3.7
UNSMIL	423	386	386	401	446	11.2
United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia	615	548	548	633	656	3.6
BINUH	116	108	108	130	139	6.9
UNAMA	836	755	755	1 038	1 063	2.4
Subtotal	**2 222**	**2 013**	**2 013**	**2 447**	**2 563**	**4.7**
Total	**2 624**	**2 380**	**2 380**	**2 891**	**3 018**	**4.4**

[a] Includes desktop computers, laptops and netbook computers.
[b] Includes international and national staff, UNV, United Nations police, United Nations military observers, government-provided personnel, military staff officers, international contractors and duty station-based experts.
[c] Based on standard requirements as outlined in the Standard Cost and Ratio Manual.

84. Similarly, the guidelines issued by the Office of Information and Communications Technology reinforced the "one computing device per user" policy as a best-practice reference to improve budget discipline, cost-effectiveness and alignment with Secretariat-wide ICT governance. Individual missions may deviate from the guidelines on the basis of operational requirements. In addition, missions have aligned their asset management practices with the updated life-cycle guidance issued by the Office, which extends the standard useful life of computing devices from four years to between five and seven years. Decisions are based on assessments of security, operational and performance considerations associated with operating devices beyond their traditional life cycle. The total proposed computing device holdings for special political missions are 4.4 per cent higher than the standard allocation. Explanations for computing device holdings that are higher than the standard allocation in specific missions are as follows:

(a) The computing device holdings at the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Syria are 12.7 per cent higher than the standard allocation, which is attributable to requirements for training purposes, security monitoring systems and servers;

(b) The computing device holdings at the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Syria are 12.7 per cent higher than the standard allocation, which is attributable to requirements for training purposes, conference and meeting rooms, and servers;

(c) The computing device holdings at UNOWAS are 14.5 per cent higher than the standard allocation, which is attributable to additional holdings required to provide for training purposes, conference and meeting rooms, data transmission and connectivity, servers and the CarLog system;

(d) The computing device holdings for United Nations support for the Cameroon-Nigeria Mixed Commission are 211.8 per cent, or two computers, higher than the standard allocation, which is attributable to additional holdings required to provide for training and meeting rooms;

(e) The computing device holdings for UNOCA are 3.7 per cent, or two computers, higher than the standard allocation, which is attributable to requirements for servers;

(f) The computing device holdings for UNSMIL are 11.2 per cent higher than the standard allocation, which is attributable to requirements for training, the CarLog system, data transmission and connectivity and servers;

(g) The computing device holdings at the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia are 3.6 per cent higher than the standard allocation, which is attributable to requirements for training purposes, Internet booths, data transmission and connectivity and servers;

(h) The computing device holdings at BINUH are 6.9 per cent higher than the standard allocation, which is attributable to requirements for training purposes and servers;

(i) The computing device holdings at UNAMA are 2.4 per cent higher than the standard allocation, which is attributable to additional holdings required to provide for training purposes, the CarLog system and servers, as well as provision for other personnel, including contractors.

85. The holdings are influenced by factors such as the need to provide for consultants and individual contractors, training facilities, Internet booths, information technology maintenance services, CarLog systems, programming of radios and fieldwork. Furthermore, based on the lessons learned during the coronavirus disease (COVID-19) pandemic, which saw a substantial increase in the use of virtual communications and remote working, it is critical to ensure the reliability of information technology equipment and infrastructure and their accessibility to all personnel, both staff and non-staff, to enable business continuity, mandate delivery and the safety and security of staff members, especially in the harsh environments where many special political missions operate.

86. The effective governance of ICT assets is a critical enabler of the Secretariat's ability to deliver mandates efficiently, transparently and sustainably. The Office of Information and Communications Technology is advancing a Secretariat-wide initiative to strengthen the integrity of ICT asset data recorded in Umoja, with the support of UNLB, the Property Management and Inventory Control Unit of the Department of Operational Support and the Global Asset Management Policy Service of the Field Operations Finance Division of the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance. This initiative is aligned with the ICT strategy and is designed to support enterprise-level visibility and oversight while fully respecting the continued accountability of individual entities under the delegation of authority framework (ST/SGB/2019/2).

87. To this end, the Office of Information and Communications Technology is implementing a global ICT asset management project from 2026 to 2027. The objectives of this initiative are to: (a) establish an ICT asset life-cycle management standard operating procedure to harmonize how ICT assets are effectively managed across the Secretariat, leveraging existing standard operating procedures, guidance and practices; (b) establish a reliable and authoritative dashboard in Umoja Analytics that provides visibility of ICT assets at both the enterprise and the entity levels; (c) improve the accuracy, completeness and integrity of ICT asset data in Umoja through data cleansing and validation; (d) enable analytical insights that support senior management and entity-level decision-making to support medium- and long-term ICT planning; and (e) strengthen data governance and accountability related to ICT assets.

IV. Budget formulation and management of resources

A. Strengthening a culture of efficiency

88. The Secretariat continues to build on its strategic approach to developing and strengthening its culture of efficiency, launched in January 2025 at a Secretary-General's seminar with all Special Representatives of the Secretary-General of peacekeeping and special political missions and Personal and Special Envoys of the Secretary-General. The theme of a culture of efficiency was once again on the agenda at the 2026 meeting, where the importance of leadership in deepening the culture of efficiency at both organizational and individual staff levels was stressed, especially in the light of the particularly difficult financial environment for the Organization. The Field Operations Finance Division of the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance is collaborating with the Leadership

Support Section of the Departments of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs and Peace Operations to plan further support to the Special Representatives of the Secretary-General of peacekeeping and special political missions to strengthen implementation of this culture of efficiency in the field, including by conducting webinars with mission senior leaders and sharing best practices across missions.

89. To support the strategic approach across missions, the Field Operations Finance Division has also: (a) organized global briefings and individual workshops with missions to guide them through the efficiency methodology; (b) collated each mission's main efficiency initiatives into an aide-memoire to inspire and inform efforts across missions; and (c) developed standardized templates for missions to calculate efficiencies, including one-time efficiency initiatives, initiatives requiring upfront investments and related break-even points. Missions have been encouraged to continue to reflect and report on these and to consider adding or expanding others. This includes considering repurposing vacant or long-vacant posts with the same mandate delivery or output. Missions were also requested to identify cost avoidance and cost reductions, which will involve taking proactive action to avoid future expenses, such as the inter-mission transfer of assets.

90. In quantifiable terms, enhancements in budgeting policy and efficiency initiatives resulted in actual savings of $16.8 million in 2025 for special political missions, compared with the $9.3 million projected. Similarly, the projected quantifiable savings and costs avoided amount to approximately $14.7 million for 2027, representing 3.6 per cent of the 2026 appropriation for the continuing missions. This represents sustainable savings for the Organization.

91. The major management improvements and efficiency measures applied and efforts to achieve sustained cost reductions and cost avoidance are reflected in the following areas:

(a) Civilian personnel, resulting from: (i) the proposed abolishment of 61 posts and the downward reclassification of 2 posts (1 P-5 and 1 P-4) in UNAMA, reflecting targeted efficiency measures through organizational optimization, functional streamlining and improved resource allocation; (ii) the reduction of high-level posts (D-1 and above), comprising the abolishment of one Under-Secretary-General post in support to the implementation of Security Council resolution 1559 (2004), one D-1 post in the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia and one D-1 post in BINUH, and the downward reclassification of one D-1 post to the P-5 level in the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Syria; (iii) the nationalization of two international posts (1 P-3 and 1 P-2) to National Professional Officers in the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia; and (iv) the promotion of national capacity for the delivery of critical mandated activities in UNSMIL;

(b) Air operations, reflecting the discontinuation of the rental and operation of fixed-wing aircraft and the consolidation of aviation requirements in the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia; the establishment of a cost-recovery arrangement for the use of air assets of UNSOH in lieu of a separate aviation contract in BINUH; and the use of commercial airlines in UNOCA in lieu of the use of special flights associated with its cost-shared fixed-wing aircraft;

(c) Facilities and infrastructure, reflecting reduced fuel consumption for generators resulting from project upgrades in UNAMA and fuel optimization measures in the Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon;

(d) Cost avoidance related to the non-acquisition of vehicles, equipment or supplies owing to the transfer of assets from UNIFIL to the Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon.

92. Further details of the efficiency measures achieved by mission are provided in the proposed budget reports of the relevant thematic clusters.

93. Most missions are also reducing the proposed resources for official travel and are instead encouraging the use of virtual meetings, where feasible, optimizing travel schedules and coordinating with partners to maximize impact while minimizing costs and prioritizing the use of online training options. The budgets also reflect economies of scale vis-à-vis the provision of materials and services and substantive support as part of mandated activities in the context of various cost-sharing arrangements.

B. Improved budgeting methodologies

94. Within the framework of the UN80 Initiative, missions were requested to explore opportunities to recalibrate their operations with a view to delivering mandates efficiently with reduced resources while maintaining due regard for the security and safety of personnel and facilities. Maintaining the momentum, the formulation of the 2027 budget proposals emphasized enhanced discipline and accountability, supported by data-driven analysis. In this context, the following principles were applied:

(a) Enhancing overall effectiveness by accommodating, where appropriate, the resource implications of new and expanded mandates within existing resources, with additional costs offset through efficiency gains, reprioritization or the redeployment of existing resources;

(b) Applying a data-driven approach to budget formulation, taking into account operational necessity, actual utilization and implementation capacity, in the context of the current financial situation. This included an analysis of the cancellation of prior-period commitments and, where appropriate, the application of zero-based budgeting to reduce reliance on historic budget levels;

(c) Adopting a multi-year perspective for construction planning and oversight of major capital projects, as well as a multi-year approach for asset management as a core component of mission budget planning, particularly with respect to air assets, and replacement planning for vehicles and ICT projects;

(d) Prioritizing the use of existing assets, including the United Nations reserve, strategic deployment stocks, the return, refurbishment and reuse programme, and identified surplus property from other entities, prior to proposing the procurement of new items.

95. With respect to air operations, missions were requested to review carefully their requirements for air assets and to maximize opportunities for the sharing of air assets across missions, with support from the Department of Operational Support. The 2027 budgetary proposals reflect requirements for air assets that are assessed as necessary and well-utilized. Budgeting for flight hours continues to be guided by the aviation budgeting policy introduced in 2025 and informed by the most recent utilization data.

96. To strengthen oversight of ICT projects and activities and related resource requirements, the budget proposals from the special political missions were subject to review and technical clearance by OICT. The process is intended to support strategic planning, align demand plans with budget proposals and implementation capacity, avoid the duplication of efforts and promote efficiency gains.

97. To ensure consistency and coherence, the proposed post actions adhere consistently to definitions pertaining to changes in staffing, and the proposals are fully justified in terms of changes in mandates or operational circumstances and workload requirements.

98. The Secretariat has ensured that all general temporary assistance positions are fully justified under each mission, providing the reasons for their proposed retention in 2027. In addition, no proposals have been made to convert these positions to regular posts. Should future assessment lead to a determination that such capacities should be regularized, proper proposals will be made in future budgets.

C. Consistent application of the most recent standard rates

99. With regard to international staff costs in field locations, the budgetary rates for net salary and staff assessment for 2027 were determined for each grade level and for each special political mission according to the following methodology:

(a) With regard to international staff, the most recent salary scale, effective 1 January 2026, as approved by the General Assembly in its resolution 80/236, was used for net salary and staff assessment for each level in the Professional and higher categories. Similarly, the net base salary scale for staff in the Field Service category is adjusted, effective 1 January 2026 (in accordance with standing practice in line with the ICSC decision contained in paragraph 270 (e) of A/45/30);

(b) The step levels selected for each grade are based on the actual average step levels for each mission as at 31 December 2025, using actual incumbency data for international staff;

(c) The post adjustment multiplier for each duty station as of April 2026 was applied to the net base salary rates.

100. With regard to national staff, the most recent salary scales as of April 2026 were used for net salary and staff assessment, with common staff costs as a percentage of net salaries, based on actual expenditure for the period from 1 January to 31 December 2025, applied to the average grade and step of national staff.

101. With regard to common staff costs, actual expenditure from 1 January to 31 December 2025 was used to calculate common staff costs as a percentage of net salaries (inclusive of post adjustment but net of staff assessment) to determine the percentage of common staff costs for 2027. However, considering the significant and exceptional expenditures related to separation costs in the context of the two early separation programmes in 2025, actual expenditure for the period was adjusted to exclude one-time separation costs arising from the early separation programme exercises. A multi-year comparative analysis and a more detailed analysis by commitment item were used for each mission to determine whether there were any other substantive or operational reasons for any significant changes.

102. With regard to danger pay, the proposed requirements reflect the discontinuation of danger pay, effective 1 April 2026, for all areas and duty stations in the Syrian Arab Republic and for Benghazi and Sirte in Libya, in line with the most recent updates from ICSC.

103. For United Nations Headquarters, offices away from Headquarters and the regional commission duty stations (New York, Geneva, Nairobi, Addis Ababa, Bangkok and Beirut), the standard costs for salaries and common staff costs for the programme budget were used.

104. With regard to military contingents (United Nations Guard Units), the most recent single rate of reimbursement to countries contributing contingent personnel to United Nations field operations in the amount of $1,448 per person per month effective from 1 July 2022, and the recreation leave allowance of $11.50 per day for up to 15 days of leave taken during each six-month period, as approved by the General Assembly in its resolutions 76/274 and 76/276, were applied. Reimbursement related to contingent-owned equipment is based on the rates adopted by the Assembly in its resolution 77/303. In this regard, the recommendations of the 2026 Working Group on Contingent-Owned Equipment (A/80/636) are under consideration by the Assembly. Should the Assembly approve the recommended net average increase of 1.58 per cent in the wet lease rates for major equipment and the reimbursement rates for self-sustainment proposed to take effect on 1 July 2026, the related additional financial implications would need to be included in the present budget proposal.

105. With regard to military advisers, observers, United Nations police and government-provided personnel, the most recent applicable mission subsistence allowance rates for each country and mission area effective from 1 January 2026 were applied, in accordance with the rates promulgated by the Office of Human Resources in December 2025.

106. With regard to experts, the estimates considered the latest fee ranges issued by the Office of Human Resources. The cost-of-living allowance for non-home-based experts in the Security Council sanctions committee panels and other support mechanisms, the most recent monthly rates of $6,600 (New York) approved by the Office of Human Resources, which took effect from 1 March 2023, have been applied to the five missions[11] that have such requirements.

[11] Analytical Support and Sanctions Monitoring Team pursuant to Security Council resolutions 1526 (2004) and 2253 (2015) concerning Islamic State in Iraq and the Levant (Da'esh), Al-Qaida and the Taliban and associated individuals and entities; Office of the Ombudsperson established pursuant to Security Council resolution 1904 (2009); Office of the Focal Point for Delisting; Panel of Experts on the Islamic Republic of Iran; and support to the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1540 (2004) on the non-proliferation of all weapons of mass destruction.

107. With regard to the rental of premises in New York, the most recent unit rate of $15,000 per person per year, effective from 1 January 2025, has been applied to those missions accommodated on the Headquarters premises in New York.

108. With respect to fuel costs, the average price per litre for the various types of fuel in the six-month period from October 2025 to March 2026 has been used as the basis for calculating the provisions for fuel costs under the relevant budget classes for 2027.

109. For ICT, the budget proposals also reflect the most recent standard rates and service charges issued by the Office of Information and Communications Technology.

D. Standardized methodology of budgeted vacancy rates

110. The Field Operations Finance Division provided guidance to all special political missions to improve the accuracy and consistency of the vacancy rate factors applied in the proposed budgets for 2027, to ensure that the proposed vacancy rates are based, as much as possible, on actual rates.

111. The proposed vacancy rates applied in the budget for 2027, for all types of personnel, have taken into account the experience to date. The assumptions considered for the proposed vacancy rates include: (a) the 12-month average vacancy rate from January to December in 2025; and (b) the actual vacancy rate as at 31 March 2026. The lower of the two was used as the budgeted vacancy rate. For missions with a high number of abolishments included in the proposed 2027 budget, namely, BINUH and UNAMA, the proposed vacancy rates for civilian personnel categories with abolishments were estimated using the total number of vacant posts and positions as at 31 March 2026 (exclusive of posts approved for phased abolishment in 2026), net of the number of posts and positions proposed for abolishment. For the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen, the proposed vacancy rates reflect their planned deployment during the period, following the closure of UNMHA. This is in line with the policy guidance to improve the accuracy and consistency of the vacancy factors applied in the proposed budgets for 2027 and to ensure that the proposed vacancy rates are based, as much as possible, on actual rates.

112. For the proposed establishment of new posts or positions, or posts or positions proposed for reassignment, a vacancy rate of 50 per cent has been applied in the calculation of costs of such posts. In addition, a vacancy rate of 50 per cent has been used for posts proposed for conversion.

113. In addition, all special political missions were requested to take into full consideration the recommendations of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions and requests from the General Assembly that vacant posts and positions should be filled expeditiously. While efforts continue to fill vacant posts as expeditiously as possible, the current liquidity situation also requires careful planning of recruitment and onboarding to minimize the financial impacts.

114. The Field Operations Finance Division provided guidance to all special political missions to take the opportunity offered during the preparation of the 2027 budget to critically review long-vacant posts with a view to abolishing vacant posts that can be covered by existing capacities, to propose reassignment or abolishment with the aim of facilitating the establishment of another function to address a more critical need, or to propose conversion to a national post.

115. Information on all posts vacant for more than two years and posts encumbered through special post allowances for more than one year is included in the supplementary information under each thematic cluster, which details the vacancy or special post allowance start dates, the level and functional title of the posts, the organizational unit and the current status of recruitment, and provides justification for the retention of long-vacant posts.

E. Harmonization of budget presentation of cluster III missions

116. In line with the recommendation of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions (A/59/569/Add.1, para. 6) that the Secretary-General should consider ways and means to

present the budgets of large missions in a manner that would be more suitable for their size and complexity, the Secretariat has reassessed the optimal ways to present the budget requirements for UNAMA, in view of the evolution of mandates and resources over the past two decades. Given that UNAMA thematically belongs to cluster III and that it shares many similar characteristics with similarly sized field missions under cluster III, the Secretary-General considers that integrating UNAMA into the report on thematic cluster III offers a more harmonized structure and presentation across missions of similar magnitude and size. This also leads to efficiencies in report production as well as reviews by the legislative bodies, in line with the objectives of the UN80 Initiative.

117. At the same time, the presentation of cluster III has been further enhanced through the inclusion of addition tables, annexes and narratives. The key benefits of the adjustments include:

(a) Greater consistency. The harmonized structure and presentation across UNAMA and the other missions within thematic cluster III are expected to enhance clarity and improve the comparability of information for Member States, the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions, oversight bodies and the Secretariat, thereby supporting more efficient analysis and review;

(b) Fewer but higher-quality reports. A reduced number of reports, from five to four, and the corresponding outputs of the Advisory Committee are expected to streamline deliberations and ease the documentation burden for legislative bodies, including the Fifth Committee. It is further expected to enhance readability and generate savings in editorial, translation and text processing costs;

(c) Maintenance of analytical depth. Detailed mission-specific budget information will continue to be provided to ensure full visibility of resource requirements and to support informed oversight. In this regard, more focused and analytical information is presented in tabular format in both the fascicles and the supplementary information, including summary views of and detailed data on all post actions by mission, as well as expanded financial information by class of expenditure.

F. Improved presentation of financial performance

118. In response to the recommendations of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions (A/80/7/Add.10, para. 70, and A/80/7/Add.1, para. 29) and endorsed by the General Assembly in its resolution 80/243, the Secretariat is continuing its efforts to enhance the financial performance reporting of the special political missions in the context of the present report, the financial performance report of the programme budget and the supplementary information provided for the special political missions. To this end, more comprehensive and detailed information on the financial performance is being provided. For supplementary information, analyses of variances for the performance and the proposed budget period are presented together for holistic perspectives in all relevant tables and sections. Information and justifications for unliquidated obligations and the cancellation of prior-period obligations are provided in table 15 and paragraphs 144 and 145 below, with further detailed information included in the financial performance report on the programme budget for 2025 (A/81/78) and the supplementary information. In addition, for air operations, mine action and construction projects for field-based special political missions under thematic cluster III, information has been included in the supplementary information for those missions, as is done for peacekeeping operations, in response to the recommendations of the Advisory Committee (A/78/7/Add.1, para. 56).

119. Additional information on the evolution of financial resources by mission over the most recent five years is provided in table 8 of the present report. Additional information on the evolution of financial resources for each mission, broken down by budget class, over that period, including both appropriation and expenditure, is provided in the supplementary information for each thematic cluster, similarly to the rest of the regular budget, in response to the recommendations of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions (A/78/7, para. 7).

V. Proposed resource requirements for 2027

A. Financial resources

Proposed resources for 2027

120. The total proposed resource requirements for 2027 relating to the 36 continuing special political missions covered in the present report amount to $422.7 million, net of staff assessment, and are inclusive of the provision for the share of special political missions in the budget of RSCE. Overall, the resource level for 2027 reflects a decrease of $113.5 million, including the impact of closing missions (with a decrease of 577 posts and positions), compared with the appropriation for 2026. Details on the financial resource requirements are presented in tables 4 to 7, while the evolution of resources over the most recent five years, as well as the requirements for 2027, is provided in table 11.

Table 4
Overview of financial resources by cluster
(Thousands of United States dollars)

	2026 appropriation[a]	*2027 requirements*	*Variance*	
			Amount	*Percentage*
	(1)	*(2)*	*(3)=(2)-(1)*	*(4)=(3)/(1)*
Cluster I	51 367.6	56 331.2	4 963.6	9.7
Cluster II	36 431.4	37 726.8	1 295.4	3.6
Cluster III	324 549.9	325 353.9	804.0	0.2
Subtotal (net of staff assessment)	**412 348.9**	**419 411.9**	**7 063.0**	**1.7**
Discontinuing and discontinued missions[b]	121 473.1	–	(121 473.1)	(100.0)
Provision for the share of special political missions for the Regional Service Centre	2 323.0	3 259.1	936.1	40.3
Total (net of staff assessment)	**536 145.0**	**422 671.0**	**(113 474.0)**	**(21.2)**

[a] The 2026 appropriation of $536,145,000 included an amount of $412,348,900 for the 36 continuing special political missions and an amount of $2,323,000 for the share of special political missions in the budget of RSCE, approved by the General Assembly in its resolutions 80/243 A and 80/254.

[b] The 2026 appropriation for these missions relates to: (a) the United Nations Transitional Assistance Mission in Somalia, the mandate of which will expire on 31 October 2026; (b) the liquidation of UNAMI, approved by the General Assembly in its resolution 80/243 A; and (c) UNMHA, the mandate of which expired 31 March 2026, approved by the Assembly in its resolution 80/254.

Table 5
Summary of resource changes between 2026 and 2027, by major factor
(Thousands of United States dollars)

	Amount	*Comments*
Appropriation for 2026	**536 145.0**	
Technical adjustments	(682.9)	Provisions at continuing rates for posts and general temporary assistance positions established in 2026, with a 50 per cent vacancy rate, as well as a full-year provision instead of nine months for operational costs in the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen
New and expanded mandates (closure)	(121 473.1)	Changes in mandate attributable to the end of the mandates of UNTMIS, pursuant to Security Council resolution 2753 (2024) and UNMHA, pursuant to resolution 2813 (2026), and the liquidation of UNAMI
Other changes	8 682.0	Includes adjustments to reflect the most recent salary rates and vacancy rates ($22.7 million), the most recent contractual rates and standard rates, the increased share for RSCE ($0.9 million) and, in BINUH, a provision for cost recovery to UNSOH following the discontinuation of mission support posts ($4 million), offset by the net impact of the abolishment and downward reclassifications of posts mostly in UNAMA, the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia and BINUH (reduction of $10.8 million), reduced troop costs and revised lease contractual arrangement in UNSMIL ($5.4 million), the reconfiguration of the aviation fleet in the Verification Mission ($3.8 million), reduced requirements for air operations in BINUH ($1.4 million) and overall lower requirements for ICT services due mainly to reduced staffing levels and Office of Information and Communications Technology rates ($1.7 million)
Total changes	**(113 474.0)**	
Proposed programme budget for 2027	**422 671.0**	

Table 6
Overview of financial resources by mission
(Thousands of United States dollars)

	2025		2026	2027	Variance	
	Appropriation	Expenditure	Appropriation	Requirements	Amount	Percentage
Mission	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)=(4)-(3)	(6)=(5)/(3)
A. Continuing missions						
Cluster I						
1. Mission of the Secretary-General's Good Offices in Cyprus	2 979.4	3 411.6	1 979.6	2 177.0	197.4	10.0
2. Office of the Special Adviser to the Secretary-General on the Prevention of Genocide	3 386.7	2 718.3	3 263.4	3 118.4	(145.0)	(4.4)
3. Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for Western Sahara	502.7	313.9	529.8	544.1	14.3	2.7
4. Support for the implementation of Security Council resolution 1559 (2004)	359.6	400.9	422.2	431.3	9.1	2.2
5. Office of the United Nations Representative to the Geneva International Discussions	1 930.5	1 858.2	952.4	997.2	44.8	4.7
6. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Syria	12 551.7	12 429.3	12 477.0	14 392.2	1 915.2	15.3
7. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Horn of Africa	2 056.1	1 786.6	1 918.4	2 013.0	94.6	4.9
8. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Great Lakes Region of Africa	4 941.7	4 760.3	4 724.7	4 940.3	215.6	4.6
9. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen	16 096.5	13 150.9	21 771.7	24 100.0	2 328.3	10.7
10. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General on Myanmar	949.9	753.4	957.2	1 314.2	357.0	37.3
11. Office of the Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Sudan	1 282.4	1 309.3	1 979.8	1 702.6	(277.2)	(14.0)
12. Senior Representative for the implementation of Security Council resolution 2792 (2025)	–	–	391.4	600.9	209.5	53.5
Subtotal, cluster I	**47 037.2**	**42 892.7**	**51 367.6**	**56 331.2**	**4 963.6**	**9.7**
Cluster II						
13. Group of Experts on the Democratic Republic of the Congo	1 549.7	1 113.9	1 313.7	1 418.5	104.8	8.0
14. Panel of Experts on the Sudan	1 132.6	436.6	1 145.3	1 186.0	40.7	3.6
15. Support to the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1718 (2006)[a]	591.3	688.6	445.6	455.1	9.5	2.1
16. Panel of Experts on Libya	1 376.4	1 092.8	1 529.7	1 574.4	44.7	2.9
17. Panel of Experts pursuant to resolution 2745 (2024)	1 300.7	877.6	1 192.9	1 206.4	13.5	1.1
18. Panel of Experts on Yemen	2 389.0	2 134.8	2 084.5	2 026.2	(58.3)	(2.8)
19. Panel of Experts on South Sudan	1 435.4	1 123.8	1 504.1	1 538.3	34.2	2.3
20. Analytical Support and Sanctions Monitoring Team pursuant to Security Council resolutions 1526 (2004) and 2253 (2015) concerning Islamic State in Iraq and the Levant (Da'esh), Al-Qaida and the Taliban and associated individuals and entities	6 158.1	5 575.8	5 366.7	5 569.0	202.3	3.8

Mission	2025 Appropriation (1)	2025 Expenditure (2)	2026 Appropriation (3)	2027 Requirements (4)	Variance Amount (5)=(4)-(3)	Variance Percentage (6)=(5)/(3)
21. Office of the Ombudsperson established pursuant to Security Council resolution 1904 (2009)	729.8	642.8	770.3	785.5	15.2	2.0
22. Panel of Experts pursuant to resolution 2713 (2023)	1 960.2	965.6	1 421.3	1 477.1	55.8	3.9
23. Panel of Experts on Haiti	1 553.0	1 427.9	1 731.8	1 744.1	12.3	0.7
24. Office of the Focal Point for Delisting	774.8	510.3	680.7	731.2	50.5	7.4
25. Panel of Experts on the Islamic Republic of Iran	–	–	2 432.4	2 511.4	79.0	3.2
26. Support to the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1540 (2004) on the non-proliferation of all weapons of mass destruction	3 465.9	2 654.2	3 429.1	3 541.1	112.0	3.3
27. Counter-Terrorism Committee Executive Directorate	12 815.7	10 977.9	11 383.3	11 962.5	579.2	5.1
Subtotal, cluster II	**37 232.6**	**30 222.6**	**36 431.4**	**37 726.8**	**1 295.4**	**3.6**
Cluster III						
28. UNOWAS	15 702.1	14 616.0	13 444.0	14 106.3	662.3	4.9
29. United Nations Regional Centre for Preventive Diplomacy for Central Asia	3 555.7	3 204.7	2 890.0	2 979.9	89.9	3.1
30. United Nations support for the Cameroon-Nigeria Mixed Commission	3 719.4	2 812.0	3 159.0	3 253.1	94.12	3.0
31. Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon	11 122.4	10 322.5	9 709.3	10 386.8	677.5	7.0
32. UNOCA	7 868.1	7 610.2	6 750.4	6 878.6	128.2	1.9
33. UNSMIL	90 588.7	83 795.8	78 738.9	83 067.4	4 328.5	5.5
34. United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia	86 582.3	74 109.1	71 752.4	75 896.9	4 144.5	5.8
35. BINUH	35 705.0	33 266.2	32 329.8	31 614.9	(714.9)	(2.2)
36. UNAMA	124 695.0	111 238.6	105 776.1	97 167.8	(8 608.3)	(8.1)
Subtotal, cluster III	**379 538.7**	**340 975.1**	**324 549.9**	**325 353.9**	**804.0**	**0.2**
Subtotal, continuing missions	**463 808.5**	**414 090.4**	**412 348.9**	**419 411.9**	**7 063.0**	**1.7**
B. Discontinuing and discontinued missions[a]						
Mission for the implementation of Security Council resolution 2231 (2015)	355.4	476.0	–	–	–	–
UNTMIS	100 177.3	86 934.3	86 646.8	–	–	–
UNMHA	31 002.1	23 893.4	11 618.7	–	–	–
UNAMI	95 399.1	104 657.1	23 207.6	–	–	–
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Burundi	–	46.8	–	–	–	–
UNIOGBIS	–	8.0	–	–	–	–

Mission	2025 Appropriation (1)	2025 Expenditure (2)	2026 Appropriation (3)	2027 Requirements (4)	Variance Amount (5)=(4)-(3)	Variance Percentage (6)=(5)/(3)
Panel of Experts on Mali	–	0.3	–	–	–	–
UNITAD	–	0.1	–	–	–	–
C. Provision for the share of special political missions for RSCE	**2 298.8**	**2 298.8**	**2 323.0**	**3 259.1**	**936.1**	**40.3**
Total (A+B+C)	**693 041.2**	**632 404.9**	**536 145.0**	**422 671.0**	**(113 474.0)**	**(21.2)**

[a] The Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Burundi and UNIOGBIS closed in 2021, the Panel of Experts on Mali closed in 2024 and UNITAD and UNITAMS closed in 2024. Some payroll adjustments for separated staff were posted in 2025.

Table 7
Overview of financial resources by category of expenditure
(Thousands of United States dollars)

		2025		2026	2027	Variance	
		Appropriation	Expenditure	Appropriation	Requirements	Amount	Percentage
	Category of expenditure	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)=(4)-(3)	(6)=(5)/(3)
A.	**Continuing missions**						
I.	**Military and police personnel**						
1.	Military observers	4 355.5	5 185.5	4 382.5	4 420.0	37.5	(0.9)
2.	Military contingents	6 744.1	6 590.6	6 609.0	5 109.0	(1 500.0)	(22.7)
3.	United Nations police	1 968.4	384.2	1 139.1	307.2	(831.9)	(73.0)
	Subtotal, military and police personnel	**13 068.0**	**12 160.3**	**12 130.6**	**9 836.2**	**(2 294.4)**	**(18.9)**
II.	**Civilian personnel**						
1.	International staff	220 507.8	223 817.1	186 137.8	194 208.4	8 070.6	4.3
2.	National Professional Officers	23 832.3	25 009.0	20 070.8	22 959.0	2 888.2	14.4
3.	National General Service staff	39 674.6	43 427.7	34 667.9	36 598.7	1 930.8	5.6
4.	United Nations Volunteers	11 688.4	11 307.6	9 437.5	9 635.1	197.6	2.1
5.	General temporary assistance	2 758.7	2 939.3	3 080.2	3 929.0	848.8	27.6
6.	Government-provided personnel	277.0	114.2	234.4	401.3	166.9	71.2
	Subtotal, civilian personnel	**298 738.8**	**306 614.9**	**253 628.6**	**267 731.5**	**14 102.9**	**5.6**
III.	**Operational costs**						
1.	Experts	12 537.7	8 256.3	11 919.3	13 690.4	111.5	0.8
2.	Consultants and consulting services	1 577.3	501.2	2 703.9	1 011.7	(32.6)	(3.1)
3.	Official travel	10 240.0	3 928.6	9 818.6	9 762.5	(56.1)	(0.6)
4.	Facilities and infrastructure	66 948.5	48 027.4	60 937.0	57 635.0	(3 302.0)	(5.4)
5.	Ground transportation	5 355.6	2 546.0	3 917.4	4 403.6	486.2	12.4
6.	Air operations	22 191.4	13 638.7	27 571.1	22 433.3	(5 137.8)	(18.6)
7.	Marine operations	177.0	63.7	462.0	340.3	(121.7)	(26.3)
8.	Communications and information technology	20 673.7	12 615.2	18 516.6	16 729.1	(1 787.5)	(9.7)
9.	Medical	2 167.8	685.7	1 935.8	1 588.2	(347.6)	(18.0)

Category of expenditure	2025 Appropriation (1)	2025 Expenditure (2)	2026 Appropriation (3)	2027 Requirements (4)	Variance Amount (5)=(4)-(3)	Variance Percentage (6)=(5)/(3)
10. Other supplies, services and equipment	10 132.7	5 052.4	8 758.0	14 200.1	5 442.1	62.1
11. Quick-impact projects	–	–	50.0	50.0	–	–
Subtotal, operational costs	**152 001.7**	**95 315.2**	**146 589.7**	**141 844.2**	**(4 745.5)**	**(3.2)**
Subtotal, continuing missions	**463 808.5**	**414 090.3**	**412 348.9**	**419 411.9**	**7 063.0**	**1.7**
B. Discontinuing and discontinued missions						
Mission for the implementation of Security Council resolution 2231 (2015)	355.4	476.0	–	–	–	–
UNTMIS	100 177.3	86 934.3	86 646.8	–	–	–
UNMHA	31 002.1	23 893.4	11 618.7	–	–	–
UNAMI	95 399.1	104 657.1	23 207.6	–	–	–
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Burundi	–	46.8	–	–	–	–
UNIOGBIS	–	8.0	–	–	–	–
Panel of Experts on Mali	–	0.3	–	–	–	–
UNITAD	–	0.1	–	–	–	–
C. Provision for the share of special political missions for RSCE	**2 298.8**	**2 298.8**	**2 332.0**	**3 259.1**	**936.1**	**40.3**
Total (A+B+C)	**693 041.2**	**632 404.9**	**536 145.0**	**422 671.0**	**(113 474.0)**	**(21.2)**

Table 8
Evolution of financial resources, 2022–2027, by mission
(Thousands of United States dollars)

Mission	2022		2023		2024		2025		2026	2027
	Appropriation	*Expenditure*	*Appropriation*	*Expenditure*	*Appropriation*	*Expenditure*	*Appropriation*	*Expenditure*	*Appropriation*	*Requirements*
A. Continuing missions										
Cluster I										
1. Mission of the Secretary-General's Good Offices in Cyprus	2 955.0	2 523.5	3 036.3	2 840.4	3 056.5	2 901.0	2 979.4	3 411.6	1 979.6	2 177.0
2. Office of the Special Adviser to the Secretary-General on the Prevention of Genocide	2 698.3	2 393.6	2 816.4	2 888.7	2 815.7	2 896.9	3 386.7	2 718.3	3 263.4	3 118.4
3. Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for Western Sahara	476.5	267.9	475.2	264.2	561.8	302.4	502.7	313.9	529.8	544.1
4. Support for the implementation of Security Council resolution 1559 (2004)	338.6	393.4	372.2	299.2	414.2	172.1	359.6	400.9	422.2	431.3
5. Office of the United Nations Representative to the Geneva International Discussions	2 045.0	1 745.4	1 950.0	1 770.4	2 032.1	1 719.7	1 930.5	1 858.2	952.4	997.2
6. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Syria	16 132.6	12 630.3	15 001.6	12 817.6	13 660.7	12 188.7	12 551.7	12 429.3	12 477.0	14 392.2
7. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Horn of Africa	1 763.6	1 586.1	1 754.5	1 805.6	1 638.1	1 863.2	2 056.1	1 786.6	1 918.4	2 013.0
8. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Great Lakes Region of Africa	5 133.9	4 406.1	5 737.9	4 672.9	4 977.8	5 246.0	4 941.7	4 760.3	4 724.7	4 940.3
9. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen	17 202.0	16 240.6	17 051.3	16 087.0	16 570.8	14 928.7	16 096.5	13 150.9	21 771.7	24 100.0
10. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General on Myanmar	1 153.5	1 223.8	1 408.6	1 084.7	1 365.3	805.1	949.9	753.4	957.2	1 314.2
11. Office of the Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Sudan	–	–	–	–	–	–	1 282.4	1 309.3	1 979.8	1 702.6
12. Senior Representative for the implementation of Security Council resolution 2792 (2025)	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	600.9
Subtotal, cluster I	**49 899.0**	**43 410.8**	**49 604.0**	**44 530.7**	**47 093.0**	**43 023.8**	**47 037.2**	**42 892.7**	**51 367.6**	**56 331.2**
Cluster II										
13. Group of Experts on the Democratic Republic of the Congo	1 419.5	1 272.4	1 524.2	1 366.8	1 556.7	1 112.8	1 549.7	1 113.9	1 313.7	1 418.5
14. Panel of Experts on the Sudan	1 073.1	956.9	1 120.4	1 012.0	1 151.5	894.3	1 132.6	436.6	1 145.3	1 186.0

Mission	2022 Appropriation	2022 Expenditure	2023 Appropriation	2023 Expenditure	2024 Appropriation	2024 Expenditure	2025 Appropriation	2025 Expenditure	2026 Appropriation	2027 Requirements
15. Support to the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1718 (2006)	3 094.5	2 943.9	3 110.6	3 065.8	3 407.9	1 454.1	591.3	688.6	445.6	455.1
16. Panel of Experts on Libya	1 431.5	1 223.3	1 410.4	1 178.3	1 456.2	1 072.9	1 376.4	1 092.8	1 529.7	1 574.4
17. Panel of Experts pursuant to resolution 2745 (2024)	1 163.8	789.2	1 193.2	890.6	1 281.6	893.7	1 300.7	877.6	1 192.9	1 206.4
18. Panel of Experts on Yemen	2 302.2	1 926.2	2 210.0	2 106.1	2 307.7	1 985.3	2 389.0	2 134.8	2 084.5	2 026.2
19. Panel of Experts on South Sudan	1 253.8	1 013.0	1 257.6	1 024.6	1 246.0	897.5	1 435.4	1 123.8	1 504.1	1 538.3
20. Analytical Support and Sanctions Monitoring Team pursuant to Security Council resolutions 1526 (2004) and 2253 (2015) concerning Islamic State in Iraq and the Levant (Da'esh), Al-Qaida and the Taliban and associated individuals and entities	5 871.5	5 827.5	5 854.9	6 091.6	6 516.9	5 729.2	6 158.1	5 575.8	5 366.7	5 569.0
21. Office of the Ombudsperson established pursuant to Security Council resolution 1904 (2009)	668.1	621.3	617.3	778.3	711.1	718.5	729.8	642.8	770.3	785.5
22. Panel of Experts pursuant to resolution 2713 (2023)	1 878.2	1 472.2	1 839.4	1 632.4	1 963.2	1 611.3	1 960.2	965.6	1 421.3	1 477.1
23. Panel of Experts on Haiti	–	1.5	1 405.7	1 402.6	1 548.5	1 291.1	1 553.0	1 427.9	1 731.8	1 744.1
24. Office of the Focal Point for Delisting	–	–	–	–	–	–	774.8	510.3	680.7	731.2
25. Panel of Experts on the Islamic Republic of Iran	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	2 432.4	2 511.4
26. Support to the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1540 (2004) on the non-proliferation of all weapons of mass destruction	3 137.7	2 598.2	3 135.5	2 280.1	3 415.1	2 442.1	3 465.9	2 654.2	3 429.1	3 541.1
27. Counter-Terrorism Committee Executive Directorate	11 278.7	11 250.7	11 424.8	10 815.4	11 669.1	11 173.3	12 815.7	10 977.9	11 383.3	11 962.5
Subtotal, cluster II	**34 572.6**	**31 896.3**	**36 104.0**	**33 644.6**	**39 421.9**	**31 276.0**	**37 232.6**	**30 222.6**	**36 431.4**	**37 726.8**
Cluster III										
28. UNOWAS	14 658.6	14 526.5	14 835.2	14 806.1	15 900.1	14 699.8	15 702.1	14 616.0	13 444.0	14 108.5
29. United Nations Regional Centre for Preventive Diplomacy for Central Asia	2 894.2	3 011.1	3 292.7	3 244.1	3 233.2	3 222.3	3 555.7	3 204.7	2 890.0	2 979.9
30. United Nations support for the Cameroon-Nigeria Mixed Commission	3 525.0	3 686.8	3 781.3	3 542.3	3 821.7	3 022.7	3 719.4	2 812.0	3 159.0	3 253.1
31. Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon	9 558.4	10 275.7	10 183.1	10 924.0	11 303.4	10 716.0	11 122.4	10 322.5	9 709.3	10 386.8
32. UNOCA	8 530.1	8 044.2	9 074.1	8 158.5	8 410.5	7 695.3	7 868.1	7 610.2	6 750.4	6 878.6
33. UNSMIL	69 262.0	82 340.9	88 046.5	86 197.7	87 763.6	85 563.5	90 588.7	83 795.8	78 738.9	83 067.4

Mission	2022		2023		2024		2025		2026	2027
	Appropriation	*Expenditure*	*Appropriation*	*Expenditure*	*Appropriation*	*Expenditure*	*Appropriation*	*Expenditure*	*Appropriation*	*Requirements*
34. United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia	66 800.6	61 117.6	67 244.3	68 380.1	78 336.7	80 104.5	86 582.3	74 109.1	71 752.4	75 896.9
35. BINUH	21 841.3	23 017.3	27 902.1	28 560.9	36 540.1	33 718.2	35 705.0	33 266.2	32 329.8	31 614.9
36. UNAMA	131 390.3	134 130.3	132 479.2	129 065.0	127 324.7	116 932.9	124 695.0	111 238.6	105 776.1	97 167.8
Subtotal, cluster III	**328 460.5**	**340 150.4**	**356 838.5**	**352 878.7**	**372 634.0**	**355 675.2**	**379 538.7**	**340 975.1**	**324 549.9**	**325 353.9**
Subtotal, continuing missions	**412 932.1**	**415 457.4**	**442 546.5**	**431 054.0**	**457 958.5**	**429 975.1**	**463 808.5**	**414 090.4**	**412 348.9**	**419 411.9**
B. Discontinuing and discontinued missions										
Mission for the implementation of Security Council resolution 2231 (2015)	1 392.6	1 230.6	1 533.5	1 397.4	1 190.4	959.6	355.4	476.0	–	–
UNTMIS	98 507.2	100 000.8	96 571.3	95 986.5	101 136.8	92 411.2	100 177.3	86 934.3	86 646.8	–
UNMHA	42 292.0	29 531.0	36 071.6	32 870.7	33 640.2	28 873.4	31 002.1	23 893.4	11 618.7	–
UNAMI	97 673.2	98 214.8	96 910.6	98 999.8	98 126.5	90 095.8	95 399.1	104 657.1	23 207.6	–
UNITAD	24 461.0	24 351.0	25 283.8	24 938.7	25 673.1	19 996.1	–	–	–	–
UNITAMS	56 319.6	56 649.0	66 128.0	62 391.3	22 162.6	17 834.7	–	–	–	–
Panel of Experts on Mali	1 144.7	852.6	1 148.6	690.9	–	0.3	–	–	–	–
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Burundi	–	(20.3)	–	78.7	–	84.5	–	–	–	–
UNIOGBIS	–	10.5	–	26.7	–	68.6	–	–	–	–
OPCW-United Nations joint mission in the Syrian Arab Republic	–	–	–	–	–	1.7	–	–	–	–
United Nations Mission in Colombia	–	–	–	–	–	23.7	–	–	–	–
United Nations Electoral Observer Mission in Burundi	–	–	–	–	–	1.4	–	–	–	–
C. Provision for the share of special political missions for RSCE	1 820.2	1 820.2	2 141.1	2 141.1	2 128.8	2 128.8	2 298.8	2 298.8	2 323.0	3 259.1
Total (A+B+C)	**736 542.6**	**728 097.8**	**768 335.0**	**750 575.9**	**742 016.9**	**682 454.9**	**693 041.2**	**632 404.9**	**536 145.0**	**422 671.0**

Variance analysis

Overall

121. The General Assembly, in its resolutions 80/243 A and 79/254, approved resources in the amount of $536.1 million for special political missions for 2026.

122. The vacancy rates for 2026 were those included in the initial proposed programme budget and were not updated in the context of the revised estimates, as a result of the reduction in the number of posts and positions proposed for 2026. The magnitude of changes proposed, which included a combination of both vacant and encumbered posts, the impact of the ongoing recruitment freeze and the early separation programme exercises, made it challenging to present updated proposed vacancy rates as part of the revised estimates proposal within the expected time frames for the submission of the present report.

123. Given that special political missions were not part of the recosting exercise carried out for the regular budget, the lack of updates to the vacancy rates means that the 2026 appropriation was underbudgeted by $19.3 million, which was noted by the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions in its report (A/80/7/Add.10, para. 26). This amount includes an estimated increase of $11.4 million for continuing missions (excluding UNTMIS and UNMHA), which had to be absorbed within the approved 2026 budget.

124. For 2027, the proposed budget amounts to $419.4 million, representing an increase of $7.1 million, or 1.7 per cent, compared with the approved budget for 2026 for these continuing missions. Within this context, the special political missions are proposing to absorb $4.3 million of the estimated additional requirements of $11.4 million referred to in paragraph 123 above through efficiency measures and the reprioritization and redeployment of existing post and non-post resources.

Cluster I

125. The proposed resource requirements for the 12 missions under thematic cluster I for 2027 amount to $56.3 million, representing a net increase of $5.0 million (9.7 per cent) compared with 2026. The overall increase is attributable primarily to: (a) increased requirements under civilian personnel, due to the application of lower vacancy rates and revised salary rates; and (b) increased operational costs, due mainly to the provisioning of a full year in 2027, compared with nine months budgeted in 2026, of requirements under air operations for the rental and operation of one fixed-wing aircraft, and under facilities and infrastructure for the rental of premises and security services for the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen following the transfer, as from 1 April 2026, of residual tasks previously performed by UNMHA pursuant to Security Council resolution 2813 (2026). The increase is offset in part by: (a) reduced requirements under communications and information technology, due to lower needs for the acquisition of equipment and reduced subscription costs for periodicals and publications; and (b) reduced requirements under ground transportation, due to lower needs for the rental of vehicles and spare parts.

Cluster II

126. The proposed resource requirements for the 15 continuing missions under thematic cluster II for 2027 amount to $37.7 million, representing a net increase of $1.3 million (3.6 per cent) compared with 2026. The overall increase is attributable primarily to: (a) increased requirements for civilian personnel resulting from the application of lower vacancy rates and the application of the most recent salary rates; and (b) increased requirements for expert fees, reflecting changes in the budgeted average monthly fees based on the current composition of expert teams. The increase is offset in part by: (a) lower estimated common staff costs for national staff, based on actual past expenditure-related staff entitlements; and (b) reduced requirements for communications and information technology, reflecting the non-recurrent provision for the acquisition of equipment included in the 2026 approved budget, as well as lower requirements for subscriptions to specialized databases and news resources to support and supplement investigations and research.

Cluster III

127. The proposed resource requirements for the nine continuing missions under thematic cluster III amount to $325.4 million, representing a net increase of $0.8 million (0.2 per cent) compared with 2026. The overall increase is attributable primarily to increased requirements for civilian personnel resulting from the application of lower vacancy rates and the application of the most recent salary rates. The increase is offset in part by reduced requirements resulting from: (a) the proposed net abolishment of 89 posts and positions, primarily in UNAMA and BINUH; (b) the reduction in the BINUH footprint due to the handover of support functions to UNSOH and the downsizing of the mandate; (c) reduced rental and maintenance costs for the premises in Tripoli based on the most recent contractual arrangement, as well as the exclusion of a non-recurrent provision for security construction approved in 2026 in UNSMIL; (d) reduced requirements under air operations due to the downsizing of the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia fleet by two aircraft and a reduction in flight hours based on the most recent utilization rates in UNSMIL and UNAMA; (e) lower communication carrier and connectivity costs, as well as reduced centralized services costs, resulting from efficiency measures taken since 2025 that have included the lower staffing levels and the closure of 10 subregional offices in the Verification Mission; (f) reduced requirements for fuel for generators reflecting energy-efficiency measures and a reduced mission footprint following the closure and nationalization of field offices approved in 2026 in UNAMA; and (g) reduced requirements for military and police personnel resulting from the reconfiguration of deployments in UNSMIL and BINUH.

Share of the cost of the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe

128. The special political missions' share of the cost of RSCE reflects an increase of $0.9 million, attributable mainly to an increase in the share of special political missions in the cost of the Centre, from 5.10 per cent in the 2025/26 period to 7.17 per cent in the 2026/27 period. This reflects the expanded client base of the Centre, following the integration of former clients of the Kuwait Joint Support Office, of which seven are continuing special political missions.[12]

129. The variance analysis of each mission is provided in table 9.

[12] Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Syria, Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen, United Nations Regional Centre for Preventive Diplomacy for Central Asia, Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon, BINUH, United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia and UNAMA.

Table 9
Variance analysis, by mission
(Thousands of United States dollars)

Mission	2026 appropriation	2027 requirements	Variance		Main contributing factors
			Amount	Percentage	
	(1)	(2)	(3)=(2)-(1)	(4)=(3)/(1)	
A. Continuing missions					
Cluster I					
1. Mission of the Secretary-General's Good Offices in Cyprus	1 979.6	2 177.0	197.4	10.0	The increase is attributable primarily to the application of lower vacancy rates for international and national staff compared with the rates applied in 2026 and updated rates for salaries and common staff costs (excluding one-time costs). The increase is offset in part by reduced requirements under communications and information technology for the maintenance of equipment and support services, adjusted to align with actual consumption, as well as for information and publication services, based on patterns of utilization in previous years, and reduced requirements for ground transportation for the rental of vehicles and related costs, due to efforts to optimize expenditure.
2. Office of the Special Adviser to the Secretary-General on the Prevention of Genocide	3 263.4	3 118.4	(145.0)	(4.4)	The decrease is attributable primarily to reduced requirements for civilian personnel, resulting from the application of a higher vacancy rate of 16.7 per cent for international staff compared with 5.8 per cent applied in 2026, and lower estimates for common staff costs for national staff based on actual past expenditure.
3. Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for Western Sahara	529.8	544.1	14.3	2.7	The increase is attributable primarily to the application of the most recent salary scales and higher estimates for common staff costs based on actual past expenditure, offset in part by the reduced requirements for facilities and infrastructure, owing to lower provisions for security services following the discontinuation of the rental of office premises for the Personal Envoy in Brussels in 2026, and spare parts and supplies in line with utilization patterns.
4. Support for the implementation of Security Council resolution 1559 (2004)	422.2	431.3	9.1	2.2	The increase is attributable primarily to higher requirements for international staff resulting from the application of the most recent salary scales and higher estimates for common staff costs based on actual past expenditure, offset in part by reduced requirements for national staff resulting from the application of lower estimates for common staff costs based on actual past expenditure.
5. Office of the United Nations Representative to the Geneva International Discussions	952.4	997.2	44.8	4.7	The increase is attributable primarily to the establishment of one General Service post at a 50 per cent vacancy rate. The increase is offset in part by: (a) reduced requirements for international staff due to the application of a higher vacancy rate of 22.2 per cent compared with 16.7 applied in 2026, as well as lower salary costs following the proposed relocation of a Political Affairs Officer (P-3) from Geneva to New York; and (b) reduced requirements for telecommunication and network services, as well as software licences, to align with actual consumption.

Mission	2026 appropriation	2027 requirements	Variance		Main contributing factors
			Amount	Percentage	
	(1)	(2)	(3)=(2)-(1)	(4)=(3)/(1)	
6. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Syria	12 477.0	14 392.2	1 915.2	15.3	The increase is attributable primarily to: (a) the application of lower vacancy rates for international and national staff compared with the rates applied in 2026; (b) the most recent salary scales; and (c) higher estimates for common staff costs based on actual past expenditure. These increases are offset in part by the discontinuation of danger pay for all areas and duty stations in the Syrian Arab Republic in accordance with the most recent updates from ICSC.
7. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Horn of Africa	1 918.4	2 013.0	94.6	4.9	The increase is attributable primarily to: (a) higher requirements for civilian personnel resulting from the application of a lower vacancy rate of zero per cent for international staff compared with 5.0 per cent applied in 2026 and updated salary scales and higher estimates for common staff costs for international staff and National Professional Officers based on actual past expenditure; (b) increased requirements for communications and information technology, reflecting updated charges for centralized services provided by the United Nations Office to the African Union, which were not provisioned for previously, as well as higher telecommunication costs due to increased prices for local services; and (c) increased requirements under ground transportation for the lease of an electric vehicle to replace one of the four ageing vehicles, which is more than 18 years old.
8. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Great Lakes Region of Africa	4 724.7	4 940.3	215.6	4.6	The increase is attributable primarily to: (a) the application of a lower vacancy rate for national staff of zero per cent compared with 12.5 applied in 2026; and (b) the application of the most recent salary scales, offset in part by the reduced requirements under communications and information technology due to lower subscription costs for periodicals, resulting from a shift to a more cost-efficient co-financing arrangement; (c) reduced requirements for official travel, due to lower ticket costs and daily subsistence allowance; and (d) reduced requirements for other supplies, services and equipment due to lower requirements for individual contractors and other services.
9. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen	21 771.7	24 100.0	2 328.3	10.7	The increase is attributable primarily to: (a) higher requirements for civilian personnel, resulting from the delayed impact of 27 new posts and positions approved in the 2026 budget at a 50 per cent vacancy rate for six months, the application of lower vacancy rates for all category of civilian personnel, updated salary scales and higher estimates for common staff costs for national staff based on actual past expenditure; and (b) increased requirements under operational costs primarily under facilities and infrastructure and air operations, reflecting requirements to cover the full year of contractual responsibilities for the rental and security services for offices, premises and aircraft previously cost-shared with UNMHA, rather than the nine months budgeted in 2026. The increases are offset in part by: (a) lower estimates for common staff costs for international staff based on actual past expenditure; (b) reduced requirements under ground transportation due to a reduced need for spare parts; and (c) decreased requirements under communications and information technology due to lower requirements for the acquisition of communications and information technology equipment.

Mission	2026 appropriation (1)	2027 requirements (2)	Variance Amount (3)=(2)-(1)	Variance Percentage (4)=(3)/(1)	Main contributing factors
10. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General on Myanmar	957.2	1 314.2	357.0	37.3	The increase is attributable primarily to the application of lower vacancy rates for international and national staff; (b) updated salary scales; and (c) higher estimates for common staff costs based on actual past expenditure.
11. Office of the Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Sudan	1 979.8	1 702.6	(277.2)	(14.0)	The decrease is attributable primarily to the application of a higher vacancy rate of 16.7 per cent for international staff compared with zero per cent applied in 2026. The decrease is offset in part by increased requirements for communications and information technology, reflecting updated charges for centralized services provided by the United Nations Office to the African Union that were not provisioned for previously, as well as higher telecommunication costs due to increased prices for local services.
12. Senior Representative for the implementation of Security Council resolution 2792 (2025)	391.4	600.9	209.5	53.5	The increase is attributable primarily to the application of a lower vacancy rate of zero percent compared with 50 per cent applied in 2026, offset in part by reduced requirements under communications and information technology due to the removal of the one-time provision for communications and information technology equipment approved in 2026.
Subtotal, cluster I	**51 367.6**	**56 331.2**	**4 963.6**	**9.7**	
Cluster II					
13. Group of Experts on the Democratic Republic of the Congo	1 313.7	1 418.5	104.8	8.0	The increase is attributable primarily to higher requirements for civilian personnel due to the application of a zero per cent vacancy rate for international staff compared with the rate of 50 per cent applied in 2026. The increase is offset in part by the lower requirements for expert fees based on the current composition of expert teams, as well as lower requirements for communications and information technology resulting from the reduced cost-shared portion of subscriptions to specialized databases and news resources to support and supplement investigations and research.
14. Panel of Experts on the Sudan	1 145.3	1 186.0	40.7	3.6	The increase is attributable primarily to increased requirements for expert fees based on the current composition of expert teams, as well as the increased civilian personnel costs resulting from the application of the most recent salary rates. The increase is offset in part by the lower requirements under communications and information technology resulting from a reduced cost-shared portion of subscriptions to specialized databases and news resources supporting investigations and research.
15. Support to the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1718 (2006)	445.6	455.1	9.5	2.1	The increase is attributable primarily to the increased international staff costs resulting from the application of the most recent salary rates. The increase is offset in part by: (a) lower estimated common staff costs for national staff based on actual past expenditure; and (b) lower requirements under operational costs due to efficiency gains achieved through the consolidation of several rental spaces into a single flexible office space, which negates the need for the rental of office equipment.
16. Panel of Experts on Libya	1 529.7	1 574.4	44.7	2.9	The increase is attributable primarily to the application of a zero per cent vacancy rate for national staff compared with 50.0 per cent applied in 2026 and the application of the most recent salary rates. The increase is offset in part by the decreased requirements for expert fees based on the current composition of expert teams, as well as the lower

Mission	2026 appropriation	2027 requirements	Variance		Main contributing factors
			Amount	Percentage	
	(1)	(2)	(3)=(2)-(1)	(4)=(3)/(1)	
					requirements under communications and information technology resulting from a reduced cost-shared portion of subscriptions to specialized databases and news resources supporting investigations and research.
17. Panel of Experts pursuant to resolution 2745 (2024)	1 192.9	1 206.4	13.5	1.1	The increase is attributable primarily to increased requirements for expert fees based on the current composition of expert teams, as well as the increased international staff costs resulting from the application of the most recent salary rates. The increase is offset in part by the lower common staff costs for national staff based on actual 2025 expenditure patterns compared with the rate applied in 2026, as well as lower requirements under communications and information technology resulting from a reduced cost-shared portion of subscriptions to specialized databases and news resources supporting investigations and research.
18. Panel of Experts on Yemen	2 084.5	2 026.2	(58.3)	(2.8)	The decrease is attributable primarily to: (a) lower requirements for expert fees based on the current composition of expert teams; (b) the discontinuation of danger pay for all areas and duty stations in Yemen in line with the most recent updates from ICSC; and (c) lower requirements under communications and information technology resulting from a reduced cost-shared portion of subscriptions to specialized databases and news resources supporting investigations and research, as well as efficiency gains achieved and the increased reliance on Internet-based communication technology.
19. Panel of Experts on South Sudan	1 504.1	1 538.3	34.2	2.3	The increase is attributable primarily to increased requirements for expert fees, based on the current composition of expert teams, as well as the increased requirements under civilian personnel costs resulting from the application of the most recent salary rates. The increase is offset in part by lower estimated common staff costs for national staff based on actual past expenditure and the lower requirements under communications and information technology resulting from a reduced cost-shared portion of subscriptions to specialized databases and news resources supporting investigations and research.
20. Analytical Support and Sanctions Monitoring Team pursuant to Security Council resolutions 1526 (2004) and 2253 (2015) concerning Islamic States in Iraq and the Levant (Da'esh), Al-Qaida and the Taliban and associated individuals and entities	5 366.7	5 569.0	202.3	3.8	The increase is attributable primarily to: (a) the application of a lower vacancy rate for international staff compared with 2026; and (b) increased requirements for expert fees based on the current composition of expert teams. The increase is offset in part by: (a) reduced requirements for national staff resulting from the application of a higher vacancy rate compared with 2026; (b) reduced requirements for the rental of office equipment through the consolidation of several rental spaces into a single flexible office space; and (c) lower requirements under communications and information technology resulting from the application of the most recent ICT standard rates and the increased reliance on Internet-based communication technology.
21. Office of the Ombudsperson established pursuant to Security Council resolution 1904 (2009)	770.3	785.5	15.2	2.0	The increase is attributable primarily to the application of the most recent salary rates, as well as higher requirements for expert fees based on the current composition of expert teams, offset in part by lower estimated common staff costs for national staff based on actual past expenditure.

Mission	2026 appropriation (1)	2027 requirements (2)	Variance Amount (3)=(2)-(1)	Variance Percentage (4)=(3)/(1)	Main contributing factors
22. Panel of Experts pursuant to resolution 2713 (2023)	1 421.3	1 477.1	55.8	3.9	The increase is attributable primarily to: (a) higher requirements for expert fees based on the current composition of expert teams; (b) increased requirements under civilian personnel costs resulting from the application of the most recent salary rates; and (c) increased requirements for telecommunications services resulting from the experts being home based. The increase is offset in part by lower estimated common staff costs for national staff based on actual past expenditure, as well as the lower requirements under communications and information technology resulting from a reduced cost-shared portion of subscriptions to specialized databases and news resources supporting investigations and research.
23. Panel of Experts on Haiti	1 731.8	1 744.1	12.3	0.7	The increase is attributable primarily to higher requirements for expert fees based on the current composition of expert teams, as well as the increased requirements under civilian personnel costs resulting from the application of the most recent salary rates. The increase is offset in part by lower estimated common staff costs for national staff based on actual past expenditure, lower requirements for security services reflecting reduced close protection support during visits to Haiti, taking into account the inter-mission cooperation with BINUH for the partial provision of such support, and the lower requirements under communications and information technology resulting from a reduced cost-shared portion of subscriptions to specialized databases and news resources supporting investigations and research.
24. Office of the Focal Point for Delisting	680.7	731.2	50.5	7.4	The increase is attributable primarily to higher requirements for civilian personnel costs due to the application of a lower vacancy rate for international staff compared with 2026, offset in part by lower estimated common staff costs for national staff based on actual past expenditure, as well as efficiency gains achieved through the discontinuation of fixed telephone communication services and an increased reliance on Internet-based communication technology.
25. Panel of Experts on the Islamic Republic of Iran	2 432.4	2 511.4	79.0	3.2	The increase is attributable primarily to higher civilian personnel costs, reflecting the full-year cost of the P-3 general temporary assistance position, compared with six months approved in 2026, as well as the application of a lower vacancy rate of 41.7 per cent for international staff compared with 50.0 per cent applied in 2026. The increase is offset in part by lower requirements under communications and information technology resulting from the exclusion of non-recurrent requirements approved in 2026 for the purchase of information technology equipment
26. Support to the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1540 (2004) on the non-proliferation of all weapons of mass destruction	3 429.1	3 541.1	112.0	3.3	The increase is attributable primarily to the application of a zero per cent vacancy rate for national staff, compared with 33.3 per cent applied in 2026, as well as the application of the most recent salary rates for international staff.

Mission	2026 appropriation	2027 requirements	Variance		Main contributing factors
			Amount	Percentage	
	(1)	(2)	(3)=(2)-(1)	(4)=(3)/(1)	
27. Counter-Terrorism Committee Executive Directorate	11 383.3	11 962.5	579.2	5.1	The increase is attributable primarily to higher civilian personnel costs, resulting from the application of the most recent salary rates for international staff. The increase is offset in part by the application of a 14.3 per cent vacancy rate for international staff, compared with 14.0 per cent applied in 2026, and the application of a 14.6 per cent vacancy rate for national staff, compared with 8.3 per cent applied in 2026, as well as lower estimated common staff costs for national staff based on actual past expenditure.
Subtotal, cluster II	**36 431.4**	**37 726.8**	**1 295.4**	**3.6**	
Cluster III					
28. UNOWAS	13 444.0	14 108.5	664.5	4.9	The increase is attributable primarily to: (a) increased requirements for civilian personnel costs due to the application of the most recent salary rates and a lower vacancy rate of 10.5 per cent compared with the rate of 15.6 per cent applied in 2026 for international staff, offset in part by the application of higher vacancy rates for national staff compared with 2026; (b) a net increase in requirements under military observers due to the application of the most recent mission subsistence rates; and (c) a net increase in requirements under operational costs, due primarily to: (i) higher fees for individual contractors and increased costs associated with the organization of events; (ii) reduced requirements under facilities and infrastructure due to reduced staffing levels in 2026, as well as the closure of the UNOWAS presence in Mauritania; (iii) reduced requirements for official travel attributable primarily efficiency gains resulting from a review of the travel plans in the light of the reduced number of staff in 2026; and (iv) reduced requirements for ground transportation due to a lower estimated consumption of fuel.
29. United Nations Regional Centre for Preventive Diplomacy for Central Asia	2 890.0	2 979.9	89.9	3.1	The increase is attributable primarily to higher requirements for civilian personnel costs, due to the application of updated salary rates and increased estimated common staff costs (common staff costs as a percentage of salary costs) for all categories of personnel, based on actual past expenditure.
30. United Nations support for the Cameroon-Nigeria Mixed Commission	3 159.0	3 253.1	94.1	3.0	The increase is attributable primarily to increased requirements for civilian personnel costs due to the application of the most recent salary rates. The increase is offset in part by: (a) the application of a higher vacancy rate of 14.3 per cent compared with 11.1 per cent applied in 2026 for international staff; and (b) the reduced requirements under operational costs due to the net effect of: (i) lower estimated contributions towards the United Nations House contribution in 2027 and reduced requirements for individual contractual services following to the closure of the office in Nouakchott; and (ii) an increase in facilities and infrastructure attributable primarily to increased contractual prices for cleaning and gardening services following the review of the minimum wages in the mission area and the appreciation of the local currency in Nigeria against the dollar, one-time maintenance costs for the offices in Yaoundé and Abuja, and additional requirements for security services based on utilization patterns and the inclusion of the entity's share of costs for the security services provided by the Department of Safety and Security.

Mission	2026 appropriation (1)	2027 requirements (2)	Variance Amount (3)=(2)-(1)	Variance Percentage (4)=(3)/(1)	Main contributing factors
31. Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon	9 709.3	10 386.8	677.5	7.0	The increase is attributable primarily to higher requirements for civilian personnel costs due to the application of lower vacancy rates of 7.1 per cent for international staff and 1.9 per cent for national General Service staff compared with 11.1 and 5 per cent applied in the 2026 budget, respectively, as well as to higher estimated salary costs for National General Service staff. The increase is further attributable to a net increase in operational cost requirements resulting from: (a) higher requirements for public information and publication services, as well as higher requirements for telecommunications and network services related to leased line, videoconferencing, and satellite services; (b) higher requirements for individual contractual services, including photography and other services supporting joint activities related to the United Nations Communications Group aimed at enhancing awareness of its importance, as well as to expanded communications and outreach efforts following the planned closure of UNIFIL; and (c) higher costs for repairs and maintenance and spare parts due to an ageing vehicle fleet. The increase is offset by reduced requirements under facilities and infrastructure due to reduced needs for furniture acquisition, lower requirements for alterations and renovations and lower estimated fuel consumption.
32. UNOCA	6 750.4	6 878.6	128.2	1.9	The increase is attributable to increased requirements for civilian personnel costs due to the application of the most recent salary scales for international and national staff, as well as operational costs attributable primarily to the prioritization of commercial airlines for official travel across the mission area as a more cost-effective logistics solution, in lieu of the use of special flights associated with the co-shared fixed-wing aircraft, and higher costs associated with the sustainment of United Nations House, including maintenance and security services managed by the United Nations Development Programme. The increase requirements were offset in part by the removal of all provisions under air operations attributable to the non-utilization of the fixed-wing during 2024 and 2025 due to liquidity constraints and the high cost of special flights.
33. UNSMIL	78 738.9	83 067.4	4 328.5	5.5	The increase is attributable primarily to increased requirements for civilian personnel costs resulting from: (a) the application of the most recent salary rates for international staff and National Professional Officers; (b) the application of the lower vacancy rates for international staff and national General Service staff compared with the rates applied in 2026; and (c) the proposed establishment of 10 posts (1 P-5, 1 FS, 6 NPO and 2 LL). The increase is offset in part by reduced requirements under operational costs and military contingents attributable primarily to: (a) reduced rental and maintenance costs for the Mission's premises in Tripoli based on the most recent contractual arrangement, as well as a non-recurrent provision for security construction approved in 2026; and (b) a reduction in the flight hours for air operations based on the most recent utilization rates, a lower planned deployment of United Nations Guard Unit personnel from an authorized strength of 234 to 167 and reduced costs for the rotation of Guard Unit personnel due to the utilization of commercial airlines rather than charter flights. The decrease in operational costs is offset by additional requirements for individual contractors in line with operational requirements to support the establishment and sustainment of the field offices in Sabha and Benghazi, as well as expansion of

Mission	2026 appropriation (1)	2027 requirements (2)	Variance Amount (3)=(2)-(1)	Variance Percentage (4)=(3)/(1)	Main contributing factors
					UNSMIL activities related to the organization of an additional mine action conference in line with the recommendation contained in the strategic review.
34. United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia	71 752.4	75 896.9	4 144.5	5.8	The increase is attributable primarily to: (a) to higher requirements under civilian personnel costs due to the application of lower vacancy rates for all category of personnel compared with the rates applied in 2026, together with updated salary scales and higher estimates for common staff costs for national staff based on actual past expenditure; and (b) higher requirements under military observers resulting from the application of the most recent mission subsistence allowance rates. The increases are offset in part by a decrease in operational costs due primarily to: (a) a decrease in requirements under air operations due to the downsizing of the Mission's fleet by two aircraft; (b) lower communication carrier and connectivity costs, as well as reduced centralized services costs, resulting from efficiency measures taken since 2025 that included lower staffing levels and the closure of 10 subregional offices; and (c) reduced requirements under marine operations reflecting a reduction in riverine activities following the closure of three subregional offices that relied on riverine vessels for mission-related transportation to locations not accessible by land. These decreases in operational costs are offset in part by higher requirements for maintenance services and individual contractors due to higher labour and service contract rates reflecting the most recent local wage levels and currency appreciation, additional requirements for facility improvements and modifications to ensure compliance with minimum security standards, as recommended by the Department of Safety and Security, and a provision for the acquisition of three armoured vehicles, not available through the United Nations fleet.
35. BINUH	32 329.8	31 614.9	(714.9)	(2.2)	The decrease is attributable primarily to reduced requirements for civilian personnel costs resulting from: (a) the proposed net abolishment of 41 posts and positions, comprising the abolishment of mission support staff because UNSOH began to provide, on a cost-recovery basis, the standard range of mission support services to BINUH as from 1 February 2026 in support of the delivery of its mandate; (b) the abolishment of posts dedicated to implementation of the police-related BINUH mandate, which has been discontinued pursuant to Security Council resolution 2814 (2026); and (c) the application of higher vacancy rates for LL staff. The decrease is further attributable to reduced requirements under military and police personnel attributable primarily to a reduction in the deployment of United Nations police officers from 48 to 5. The decrease in civilian personnel costs was offset in part by a net increase in requirements under operational costs due primarily to the provision of $4.0 million to cover the cost reimbursement to UNSOH or the delivery of the standard range of mission support services to BINUH on a cost-recovery basis. With the reduction in the mission's footprint and handover of support functions to UNSOH, requirements under official travel, air operations, communications and information technology, ground transportation and medical were reduced.

Mission	2026 appropriation	2027 requirements	Variance		Main contributing factors
			Amount	Percentage	
	(1)	(2)	(3)=(2)-(1)	(4)=(3)/(1)	
36. UNAMA	105 776.1	97 167.8	(8 608.3)	(8.1)	The decrease is attributable primarily to: (a) reduced requirements for civilian personnel costs due to the abolishment of 61 posts and positions, the absence in 2027 of a one-time provision included in the 2026 appropriation for separation costs related to the abolishment of 38 posts in the Kuwait Joint Support Office, and the application of a higher vacancy rate of 13.9 per cent for international staff compared with a vacancy rate of 10.4 per cent applied in 2026; (b) reduced requirements for fuel for generators reflecting energy-efficiency measures and a reduced mission footprint following the closure and nationalization of field offices approved in 2026; (c) reduced requirements for air operations due to a decrease in flight hours based on historical utilization patterns: (d) removal of the one-time provision for the acquisition of vehicle workshop equipment approved in 2026; and (e) lower costs for medical services based on new contractual terms and an operating modality. The decrease is offset by additional requirements for mine detection and mine-clearing services to strengthen mine action coordination, including support for the Mine Action Technical Cell in line with para. 5 (j) of Security Council resolution 2626 (2022).
Subtotal, cluster III	**324 549.9**	**325 353.9**	**804.0**	**0.2**	
Subtotal, continuing missions	**412 348.9**	**419 411.9**	**7 063.0**	**1.7**	
B. Discontinuing and discontinued missions					
UNTMIS	86 646.8	–	(86 646.8)	–	The Mission’s mandate is set to expire in October 2026.
UNMHA	23 421.9	–	(23 421.9)	–	The Mission’s mandate expired 31 March 2026 pursuant to Security Council resolution 2813 (2026).
UNAMI	23 207.6	–	(23 207.6)	–	The Mission’s field-based liquidation is scheduled for completion by 30 September 2026.
C. Provision for the share of special political missions for RSCE	**2 323.0**	**3 259.1**	**936.1**	**40.3**	The increase is attributable primarily to an increase in the share of special political missions in the cost of the Centre, from 5.10 per cent in the 2025/26 period to 7.17 cent in the 2026/27 period, reflecting the expanded client base of the Centre, following the integration of former clients from the Kuwait Joint Support Office, of which seven are continuing special political missions.
Total (A+B+C)	**536 145.0**	**422 671.0**	**(113 474.0)**	**(21.2)**	

Contribution of extrabudgetary resources to mandate implementation in special political missions

130. Extrabudgetary resources, in particular voluntary contributions, continue to be used for bolstering backstopping, surge requirements for good offices, crisis situations and other activities related to the mandates of special political missions. Such resources have also been critical for support for inter-mission activities and for visits by desk officers and senior officials to missions.

131. Voluntary contributions have been important in enabling special political missions to implement targeted projects in pursuit of the implementation of their mandates. In the Great Lakes region, the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General utilizes extrabudgetary resources to support the implementation of the project for the reduction in small arms circulation. The Office of the Special Adviser to the Secretary-General on the Prevention of Genocide utilizes extrabudgetary resources to support the capacity-building and technical assistance programme and the preparation of the 2026 report of the Secretary-General on the responsibility to protect. The Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen continues to utilize extrabudgetary resources to support the Special Envoy's efforts to reach sustainable and inclusive agreements to end the conflict in the country. The Office of the Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Sudan utilizes extrabudgetary resources to support the provision of critical expertise on security arrangements and ceasefires, as well as support for communication strategies and media engagement for the Personal Envoy. UNSMIL continues to utilize extrabudgetary resources to support activities focused on facilitating an inclusive intra-Libyan political process, an economic track and capacity-building on human rights. UNAMA utilizes extrabudgetary resources to support climate change activities in local peace initiatives and political engagement and meetings with regional governments, and the advancement of international engagement on Afghanistan in a more coherent, coordinated and structured manner in line with the recommendations of the independent assessment on Afghanistan (S/2023/856).

132. In addition, voluntary contributions fund specific mission initiatives. The mission in support of the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1540 (2004) on the non-proliferation of all weapons of mass destruction to non-State actors used extrabudgetary resources in 2025 to support the participation of Member States in activities aimed at advancing the implementation of the resolution, including capacity-building and outreach initiatives. Furthermore, the Counter-Terrorism Committee Executive Directorate utilizes extrabudgetary resources to support the implementation of Committee-mandated activities and relevant projects, including the organization of meetings in line with the Committee's approved programme of work and the promotion of international cooperation in counter-terrorism. This includes targeted capacity-building initiatives, such as projects aimed at strengthening national capabilities to detect and disrupt terrorist activities, including through the use of information and communications technologies, as well as specialized initiatives on forensics and biometrics in Africa.

133. Voluntary contributions also bolster backstopping capacity at Headquarters, including by funding regular visits to the field, thereby enabling the development of closer collaboration with missions. Such visits have facilitated a better understanding and analysis of the context in which missions are operating and how they can be better supported to implement their mandates.

134. In addition, cost-recovery revenue in some missions, such as UNAMA, enabled them to provide shared common services to other agencies, funds and programmes in the same location, to benefit from economies of scale. This is in line with the direction of consolidating support services at the country level and the requirement for integrated support across the United Nations system for the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development. Cost recovery is governed by rule 105.11 of the Financial Regulations and Rules of the United Nations, in addition to policy guidance issued by the Controller.

135. Extrabudgetary resources (including both voluntary contributions and cost-recovery revenue) are estimated at $33.0 million for 2027, compared with an estimated $33.3 million in 2026. The projected decrease of $0.3 million for 2027 is attributable to the anticipated conclusion or non-extension of some projects or activities in the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General on Myanmar, United Nations support for the Cameroon-Nigeria Mixed Commission and UNAMA,

offset by increases in contributions in the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Great Lakes Region of Africa and the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen, based on current projections. Extrabudgetary resources have been important in enabling special political missions to implement targeted projects in pursuit of their mandates. However, while missions continue to engage actively in fundraising activities, it remains a challenge to secure funding or pledges for 2027 sufficiently in advance to enable projections to be made with greater certainty.

B. Human resources

136. The number of civilian personnel proposed for 2027, including international and national staff, United National Volunteers and general temporary assistance positions, reflects an overall decrease of 89 posts and positions, from 2,393 to 2,304. Details on the human resources requirements by cluster, by mission and by category of personnel are presented in tables 13 to 16.

Backstopping support at Headquarters

137. Special political missions rely on Headquarters for backstopping support for a wide range of functions. The Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs is leading and providing substantive backstopping to 34 of the 36 continuing special political missions by ensuring regular and effective communication between the missions and United Nations entities in New York and regular liaison with Member States through their permanent missions to the United Nations and preparing a wide range of substantive material, including briefing materials for the Security Council and regular reports of the Secretary-General, among other functions. Administrative support is being provided by One Executive Office of the Department of Operational Support.

138. Special political missions also benefit from operational support and advisory services in the areas of human resources and supply chain management provided by the Department of Operational Support; budgetary and financial services, asset and property management policy support and assistance in accountability systems provided by the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance; and information technology support delivered by the Office of Information and Communications Technology. Special political missions also rely on support from Headquarters in thematic and operational areas such as constitution-making, electoral assistance, mediation, best practices, military and police planning/force generation, rule of law and security institutions.

139. As outlined in detail in the report of the Secretary-General on the review of arrangements for funding and backstopping special political missions (A/66/340), which remained pending before the General Assembly, there is no dedicated mechanism to ensure relevant capacities for backstopping special political missions at Headquarters, in contrast to peacekeeping operations, which can draw on the support account for peacekeeping operations.

140. In 2026, a total of 36 posts (1 D-1, 8 P-5, 18 P-4, 3 P-3 and 6 General Service (Other level)) are being funded from special political missions. In 2027, a total of 30 such posts (1 D-1, 7 P-5, 14 P-4, 2 P-3 and 6 General Service (Other level)) are proposed, reflecting the abolishment of 6 posts in 2026 due to mandate termination, comprising 2 posts (1 P-4 and 1 P-3), effective 31 March 2026, funded from UNMHA, and 4 posts (1 P-5 and 3 P-4) funded from UNTMIS.

141. While the resources included in the budgets of special political missions for backstopping support are fundamental for the Secretariat to provide support to special political missions, the regular budget and extrabudgetary resources of the Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs are often also required to ensure adequate support. Similarly, the regular budget and extrabudgetary resources of the Office for Disarmament Affairs are used to provide administrative support to the mission in support of the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1540 (2004) on the non-proliferation of all weapons of mass destruction.

Table 10
Human resources: summary of changes by cluster

	Posts					
	International	*National*	*Subtotal*	*UNV*	*GTA*	*Total*
A. Continuing missions						
Cluster I						
Approved 2026[a]	142	106	248	–	5	253
Proposed 2027	141	107	248	–	5	253
Change	**(1)**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**
Cluster II						
Approved 2026	73	25	98	–	1	99
Proposed 2027	73	25	98	–	1	99
Change	–	–	–	–	–	–
Cluster III						
Approved 2026[b]	776	1 026	1 802	223	16	2 041
Proposed 2027	733	975	1 708	225	19	1 952
Change	**(43)**	**(51)**	**(94)**	**2**	**3**	**(89)**
Total, continuing missions						
Approved 2026	**991**	**1 157**	**2 148**	**223**	**22**	**2 393**
Proposed 2027	**947**	**1 107**	**2 054**	**225**	**25**	**2 304**
Change	**(44)**	**(50)**	**(94)**	**2**	**3**	**(89)**
B. Discontinuing mission						
UNTMIS						
Approved 2026: as at 1 January 2026	131	110	241	7	–	248
Abolishments in 2026[c]	(131)	(110)	(241)	(7)	–	(248)
Approved 2026: as at 31 December 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–
Proposed 2027	–	–	–	–	–	–
Change	–	–	–	–	–	–
UNMHA						
Approved 2026: as at 1 January 2026	48	77	125	–	2	127
Abolishments in 2026[d]	(48)	(77)	(125)	–	(2)	(127)
Approved 2026: as at 31 December 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–
Proposed 2027	–	–	–	–	–	–
Change	–	–	–	–	–	–
UNAMI						
Approved 2026: as at 1 January 2026	49	64	113	–	–	113
Abolishments in 2026[e]	(49)	(64)	(113)	–	–	(113)
Approved 2026: as at 31 December 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–
Proposed 2027	–	–	–	–	–	–
Change	–	–	–	–	–	–

	Posts					
	International	*National*	*Subtotal*	*UNV*	*GTA*	*Total*
Total, discontinuing missions						
Approved 2026: as at 1 January 2026	**228**	**251**	**479**	**7**	**2**	**488**
Abolishments in 2026[e]	**(228)**	**(251)**	**(479)**	**(7)**	**(2)**	**(488)**
Approved 2026: as at 31 December 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–
Proposed 2027	–	–	–	–	–	–

[a] Includes 1 P-4 post established effective 1 April 2026, and 24 posts (1 D-1, 1 P-4, 1 P-3, 6 FS, 1 NPO and 14 LL) established effective 1 July 2026.

[b] Excludes 42 posts abolished as at 1 July 2026 (1 P-5 in the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia, 38 in the Kuwait Joint Support Office (1 P-5, 1 P-4, 2 P-3, 1 P-2, 14 FS and 19 LL) and 1 P-5 post) in UNAMA, and 2 LL posts in the Kuwait Joint Support Office in BINUH.

[c] In line with the phased abolishment of 234 posts (1 USG, 2 ASG, 5 D-1, 17 P-5, 30 P-4, 23 P-3, 46 FS, 73 NPO and 37 LL) and 7 UNV (6 international and 1 national) abolished as at 31 October 2026, and 7 posts (1 D-1, 1 P-5, 3 P-4 and 2 FS) abolished as at 31 December 2026.

[d] In line with the phased abolishment of 125 posts, comprising: (a) as at 31 March 2026, 70 posts (1 D-2, 3 P-5, 8 P-4, 7 P-3, 8 FS, 10 NPO and 33 LL); (b) as at 30 April 2026, 6 posts (2 FS and 4 LL); (c) as at 31 May 2026, 1 FS post; and (d) as at 30 June 2026, 48 posts (1 D-1, 1 P-5, 1 P-4, 3 P-3, 12 FS, 1 NPO and 29 LL); as well as 2 general temporary positions (1 P-4 and 1 P-3) abolished as at 31 March 2026.

[e] In line with the phased abolishment of 113 posts, comprising: (a) as at 31 March 2026, 9 posts (1 ASG, 1 P-4, 3 FS, 1 NPO and 3 LL); (b) as at 30 June 2026, 37 posts (3 P-4, 1 P-3, 6 FS, 5 NPO and 22 LL); and (c) as at 30 September 2026, 67 posts (1 D-1, 2 P-5, 10 P-4, 3 P-3, 18 FS, 8 NPO and 25 LL).

Table 11
Human resources: international and national posts and United Nations Volunteer positions

	International staff posts											*National staff posts*					*UNV*			
	USG	*ASG*	*D-2*	*D-1*	*P-5*	*P-4*	*P-3*	*P-2/1*	*Subtotal*	*FS*	*Subtotal*	*NPO*	*PL*	*OL*	*LL*	*Subtotal*	*International*	*National*	*Subtotal*	*Total*
Cluster I																				
1. Mission of the Secretary-General's Good Offices in Cyprus																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	1	2	1	2	–	6	3	9	–	–	1	3	4	–	–	–	13
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**2**	**1**	**2**	**–**	**6**	**3**	**9**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**3**	**4**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**13**
2. Office of the Special Adviser to the Secretary-General on the Prevention of Genocide																				
Approved 2026	1	1[a]	–	–	2	3	2	1	10	–	10	–	–	2	–	2	–	–	–	12
Proposed 2027	**1**	**1[a]**	**–**	**–**	**2**	**3**	**3**	**2**	**12**	**–**	**12**	**–**	**–**	**2**	**–**	**2**	**–**	**5**	**5**	**19**
3. Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for Western Sahara																				
Approved 2026	1[b]	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	2	–	2	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	**2**
Proposed 2027	**1[b]**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**2**	**–**	**2**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**2**
4. Support for the implementation of Security Council resolution 1559 (2004)																				
Approved 2026	1[c]	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	2	–	2	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	3
Abolishment	(1)	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	(1)	–	(1)	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	(1)
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**2**
5. Office of the United Nations Representative to the Geneva International Discussions																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	–	2	1	–	3	–	3	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	3
Establishment	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	1
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**2**	**1**	**–**	**3**	**–**	**3**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**4**
6. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Syria																				
Approved 2026	1	1	1	3	5	10	4	–	**25**	5	30	1	–	5	29	**35**	–	–	–	**65**
Reclassification	–	–	–	(1)	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Proposed 2027	**1**	**1**	**1**	**2**	**6**	**10**	**4**	**–**	**25**	**5**	**30**	**1**	**–**	**5**	**29**	**35**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**65**

	International staff posts											*National staff posts*					*UNV*			
	USG	*ASG*	*D-2*	*D-1*	*P-5*	*P-4*	*P-3*	*P-2/1*	*Subtotal*	*FS*	*Subtotal*	*NPO*	*PL*	*OL*	*LL*	*Subtotal*	*International*	*National*	*Subtotal*	*Total*
7. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Horn of Africa																				
Approved 2026	1	–	–	1	–	2	1	–	5	–	5	2	–	–	2	4	–	–	–	9
Proposed 2027	**1**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**2**	**1**	**–**	**5**	**–**	**5**	**2**	**–**	**–**	**2**	**4**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**9**
8. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Great Lakes Region of Africa																				
Approved 2026	1	–	–	2	4	5	5	–	17	1	18	–	–	–	5	5	–	–	–	23
Proposed 2027	**1**	**–**	**–**	**2**	**4**	**5**	**5**	**–**	**17**	**1**	**18**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**5**	**5**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**23**
9. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen																				
Approved 2026[d]	1	–	–	3	3	15	8	1	31	20	51	11	–	–	43	54	–	–	–	105
Proposed 2027	**1**	**–**	**–**	**3**	**3**	**15**	**8**	**1**	**31**	**20**	**51**	**11**	**–**	**–**	**43**	**54**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**105**
10. Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General on Myanmar																				
Approved 2026	1[a]	–	–	1	1	1	–	–	4	–	4	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	4
Proposed 2027	**1**[a]	**–**	**–**	**1**	**1**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**4**	**–**	**4**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**4**
11. Office of the Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Sudan																				
Approved 2026	1	–	–	–	2	3	–	–	6	–	6	–	–	–	1	1	–	–	–	7
Proposed 2027	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**2**	**3**	**–**	**–**	**6**	**–**	**6**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**7**
12. Senior Representative for the implementation of Security Council resolution 2792 (2025)																				
Approved 2026	–	1[a]	–	–	–	1	–	–	2	–	2	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	2
Proposed 2027	**–**	**1**[a]	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**2**	**–**	**2**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**2**
Cluster II																				
13. Group of Experts on the Democratic Republic of the Congo																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**
14. Panel of Experts on the Sudan																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**

	International staff posts											*National staff posts*					*UNV*			
	USG	*ASG*	*D-2*	*D-1*	*P-5*	*P-4*	*P-3*	*P-2/1*	*Subtotal*	*FS*	*Subtotal*	*NPO*	*PL*	*OL*	*LL*	*Subtotal*	*International*	*National*	*Subtotal*	*Total*
15. Support to the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1718 (2006)																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	1	–	1	–	–	1	–	–	–	2
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**2**
16. Panel of Experts on Libya																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	1	–	1	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	2
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**2**
17. Panel of Experts pursuant to resolution 2745 (2024)																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	1	–	1	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	2
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**2**
18. Panel of Experts on Yemen																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	1	3	4	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	4
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**3**	**4**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**4**
19. Panel of Experts on South Sudan																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	1	–	1	–	–	2	–	2	–	–	–	3
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**2**	**–**	**2**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**3**
20. Analytical Support and Sanctions Monitoring Team pursuant to Security Council resolutions 1526 (2004) and 2253 (2015) concerning Islamic State in Iraq and the Levant (Da'esh), Al-Qaida and the Taliban and associated individuals and entities																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	1	4	6	–	11	–	11	–	–	5	–	5	–	–	–	16
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**4**	**6**	**–**	**11**	**–**	**11**	**–**	**–**	**5**	**–**	**5**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**16**
21. Office of the Ombudsperson established pursuant to Security Council resolution 1904 (2009)																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	2
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**2**
22. Panel of Experts pursuant to resolution 2713 (2023)																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	1	–	1	–	–	1	2	3	–	–	–	4
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**2**	**3**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**4**

	International staff posts											*National staff posts*					*UNV*			
	USG	*ASG*	*D-2*	*D-1*	*P-5*	*P-4*	*P-3*	*P-2/1*	*Subtotal*	*FS*	*Subtotal*	*NPO*	*PL*	*OL*	*LL*	*Subtotal*	*International*	*National*	*Subtotal*	*Total*
23. Panel of Experts on Haiti																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	1	–	1	–	2	–	2	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	3
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**2**	**–**	**2**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**3**
24. Office of the Focal Point for Delisting																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	–	1	1	–	2	–	2	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	3
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**1**	**–**	**2**	**–**	**2**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**3**
25. Panel of Experts on the Islamic Republic of Iran																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	2
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**2**
26. Support to the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1540 (2004) on the non-proliferation of all weapons of mass destruction																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	1	–	2	–	3	–	3	–	–	2	–	2	–	–	–	5
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**2**	**–**	**3**	**–**	**3**	**–**	**–**	**2**	**–**	**2**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**5**
27. Counter-Terrorism Committee Executive Directorate																				
Approved 2026	–	1	1	2	8	18	9	3	42	–	42	–	–	6	–	6	–	–	–	48
Proposed 2027	**–**	**1**	**1**	**2**	**8**	**18**	**9**	**3**	**42**	**–**	**42**	**–**	**–**	**6**	**–**	**6**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**48**
Cluster III																				
28. UNOWAS																				
Approved 2026	1	1	–	1	6	13	10	1	33	5	38	9	–	–	18	27	–	–	–	65
Proposed 2027	**1**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**6**	**13**	**10**	**1**	**33**	**5**	**38**	**9**	**–**	**–**	**18**	**27**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**65**
29. United Nations Regional Centre for Preventive Diplomacy for Central Asia																				
Approved 2026	–	1	–	–	1	2	1	–	5	1	6	4	–	–	14	18	–	–	–	24
Proposed 2027	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**2**	**1**	**–**	**5**	**1**	**6**	**4**	**–**	**–**	**14**	**18**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**24**
30. United Nations support for the Cameroon-Nigeria Mixed Commission																				
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	1	5	–	–	6	1	7	–	–	–	2	2	–	–	–	9
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**5**	**–**	**–**	**6**	**1**	**7**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**2**	**2**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**9**

	International staff posts											*National staff posts*					*UNV*			
	USG	*ASG*	*D-2*	*D-1*	*P-5*	*P-4*	*P-3*	*P-2/1*	*Subtotal*	*FS*	*Subtotal*	*NPO*	*PL*	*OL*	*LL*	*Subtotal*	*International*	*National*	*Subtotal*	*Total*
31. Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon																				
Approved 2026	1	1	–	1	2	5	1	–	11	3	14	5	–	–	52	57	–	–	–	71
Proposed 2027	**1**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**2**	**5**	**1**	**–**	**11**	**3**	**14**	**5**	**–**	**–**	**52**	**57**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**71**
32. UNOCA																				
Approved 2026	1	–	–	2	2	10	4	–	19	7	26	3	–	–	10	13	–	1	1	40
Proposed 2027	**1**	**–**	**–**	**2**	**2**	**10**	**4**	**–**	**19**	**7**	**26**	**3**	**–**	**–**	**10**	**13**	**–**	**1**	**1**	**40**
33. UNSMIL																				
Approved 2026	1	2	–	7	10	40	29	2	91	124	215	17	–	1	91	109	5	–	5	329
Establishment	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	–	1	1	2	6	–	–	2	8	–	–	–	10
Conversion	–	–	–	–	–	–	(1)	–	(1)	–	(1)	1	–	–	–	1	–	–	–	–
Proposed 2027	**1**	**2**	**–**	**7**	**11**	**40**	**28**	**2**	**91**	**125**	**216**	**24**	**–**	**1**	**93**	**118**	**5**	**–**	**5**	**339**
34. United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia																				
Approved 2026[e]	1	1	–	5	23	36	53	1	120	45	165	93	–	1	80	174	100	20	120	459
Abolishment	–	–	–	(1)	–	–	–	–	(1)	–	(1)	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	(1)
Establishment	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	1	–	–	–	1
Conversion	–	–	–	–	–		(1)	(1)	(2)	–	(2)	2	–	–	–	2	–	–	–	–
Proposed 2027	**1**	**1**	**–**	**4**	**23**	**35**	**53**	**–**	**117**	**45**	**162**	**95**	**–**	**1**	**81**	**177**	**100**	**20**	**120**	**459**
35. BINUH																				
Approved 2026[f]	1	–	1	4	9	16	8	2	41	42	83	19	–	–	35	54	1	–	1	138
Abolishment	–	–	–	(1)	(1)	(1)	(6)	(2)	(11)	(8)	(19)	(1)	–	–	(24)	(25)	(1)	–	(1)	(45)
Proposed 2027	**1**	**–**	**1**	**3**	**8**	**15**	**2**	**–**	**30**	**34**	**64**	**18**	**–**	**–**	**11**	**29**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**93**

	International staff posts											*National staff posts*					*UNV*			
	USG	*ASG*	*D-2*	*D-1*	*P-5*	*P-4*	*P-3*	*P-2/1*	*Subtotal*	*FS*	*Subtotal*	*NPO*	*PL*	*OL*	*LL*	*Subtotal*	*International*	*National*	*Subtotal*	*Total*
36. UNAMA																				
Approved 2026[g]	1	2	1	5	21	48	44	5	127	95	222	103	–	1	468	572	60	36	96	890
Abolishment	–	–	–	–	–	(5)	(2)	–	(7)	(15)	(22)	(10)	–	–	(28)	(38)	–	–	–	(60)
Establishment	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	3	–	3	3
Reclassification	–	–	–	–	(1)	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Proposed 2027	**1**	**2**	**1**	**5**	**20**	**43**	**43**	**5**	**120**	**80**	**200**	**93**	**–**	**1**	**440**	**534**	**63**	**36**	**99**	**833**
Total, continuing missions																				
Approved 2026	**16**	**12**	**4**	**38**	**105**	**245**	**200**	**16**	**636**	**355**	**991**	**267**	**1**	**34**	**855**	**1 157**	**166**	**57**	**223**	**2 371**
Abolishment	**(1)**	**–**	**–**	**(2)**	**(1)**	**(6)**	**(8)**	**(2)**	**(20)**	**(23)**	**(43)**	**(11)**	**–**	**–**	**(52)**	**(63)**	**(1)**	**–**	**(1)**	**(107)**
Establishment	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**1**	**2**	**6**	**–**	**1**	**3**	**10**	**3**	**–**	**3**	**15**
Reclassification	**–**	**–**	**–**	**(1)**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**
Conversion	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**(2)**	**(1)**	**(3)**	**–**	**(3)**	**3**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**3**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**
Proposed 2027	**15**	**12**	**4**	**35**	**105**	**239**	**191**	**13**	**614**	**333**	**947**	**265**	**1**	**35**	**806**	**1 107**	**168**	**57**	**225**	**2 279**
Discontinuing missions																				
UNTMIS																				
Approved 2026: as at 1 January 2026	1	2	–	6	18	33	23	–	83	48	131	73	–	–	37	110	6	1	7	248
Abolishment in 2026[h]	(1)	(2)	–	(6)	(18)	(33)	(23)	–	(83)	(48)	(131)	(73)	–	–	(37)	(110)	(6)	(1)	(7)	(248)
Approved 2026: as at 31 December 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Proposed 2027	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
UNMHA																				
Approved 2026: as at 1 January 2026	–	–	1	1	4	9	10	–	25	23	48	11	–	–	66	77	–	–	–	125
Abolishment in 2026[i]	–	–	(1)	(1)	(4)	(9)	(10)	–	(25)	(23)	(48)	(11)	–	–	(66)	(77)	–	–	–	(125)
Approved 2026: as at 31 December 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Proposed 2027	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–

	International staff posts											*National staff posts*					*UNV*			
	USG	*ASG*	*D-2*	*D-1*	*P-5*	*P-4*	*P-3*	*P-2/1*	*Subtotal*	*FS*	*Subtotal*	*NPO*	*PL*	*OL*	*LL*	*Subtotal*	*International*	*National*	*Subtotal*	*Total*
UNAMI				–																
Approved 2026: as at 1 January 2026	–	1	–	1	2	14	4	–	22	27	49	14	–	–	50	64	–	–	–	113
Abolishment in 2026[j]	–	(1)	–	(1)	(2)	(14)	(4)	–	(22)	(27)	(49)	(14)	–	–	(50)	(64)	–	–	–	(113)
Approved 2026: as at 31 December 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Proposed 2027	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–

[a] The Assistant Secretary-General is on a $1-a-year contract.
[b] The Under-Secretary-General is on a when-actually-employed contract.
[c] The Under-Secretary-General is on a $1-a-year contract.
[d] Includes 1 P-4 post established effective 1 April 2026 and 24 posts (1 D-1, 1 P-4, 1 P-3, 6 FS, 1 NPO and 14 LL) established effective 1 July 2026.
[e] Excludes 1 P-5 post abolished as at 1 July 2026.
[f] Excludes 2 LL posts in the Kuwait Joint Support Office abolished as at 1 July 2026.
[g] Excludes 39 posts abolished effective 1 July 2026 (38 Kuwait Joint Support Office posts (1 P-5, 1 P-4, 2 P-3, 1 P-2, 14 FS and 19 LL and 1 P-5 post)).
[h] In line with the phased abolishment of 234 posts (1 USG, 2 ASG, 5 D-1, 17 P-5, 30 P-4, 23 P-3, 46 FS, 73 NPO and 37 LL) and 7 UNV (6 international and 1 national) abolished as at 31 October 2026, and 7 posts (1 D-1, 1 P-5, 3 P-4 and 2 FS) abolished as at 31 December 2026.
[i] In line with phased abolishment of 125 posts, comprising: (a) as at 31 March 2026, 70 posts (1 D-2, 3 P-5, 8 P-4, 7 P-3, 8 FS, 10 NPO and 33 LL); (b) as at 30 April 2026, 6 posts (2 FS and 4 LL); (c) as at 31 May 2026, 1 FS post; and (d) as at 30 June 2026, 48 posts (1 D-1, 1 P-5, 1 P-4, 3 P-3, 12 FS, 1 NPO and 29 LL).
[j] In line with the phased abolishment of 113 posts, comprising: (a) as at 31 March 2026, 9 posts (1 ASG, 1 P-4, 3 FS, 1 NPO and 3 LL); (b) as at 30 June 2026, 37 posts (3 P-4, 1 P-3, 6 FS, 5 NPO and 22 LL); and (c) as at 30 September 2026, 67 posts (1 D-1, 2 P-5, 10 P-4, 3 P-3, 18 FS, 8 NPO and 25 LL).

Table 12
Human resources: general temporary assistance positions and other personnel

	General temporary assistance positions								*Other personnel*				
	International staff					*National staff*							
	D-1	*P-5*	*P-4*	*P-3*	*P-2/1*	*NPO*	*GS*	*LL*	*Military advisers/ observers*	*United Nations Guard Unit personnel*	*United Nations police*	*Government-provided personnel*	*Total*
Office of the Special Adviser to the Secretary-General on the Prevention of Genocide													
Approved 2026[a]	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	2
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**2**
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen													
Approved 2026[b]	–	–	–	1	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	2
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**2**
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General on Myanmar													
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	–	–	1
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**
Panel of Experts on the Islamic Republic of Iran													
Approved 2026[c]	–	–	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**
UNOWAS													
Approved 2026[d]	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	1	–	1	–	3
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**3**
United Nations support for the Cameroon-Nigeria Mixed Commission													
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	–	1
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**
UNSMIL													
Approved 2026[e]	–	1	2	1	–	3	–	–	–	234	–	7	248
Proposed 2027	**–**	**1**	**2**	**1**	**–**	**3**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**234**	**–**	**7**	**248**

	General temporary assistance positions								*Other personnel*				
	International staff					*National staff*							
	D-1	*P-5*	*P-4*	*P-3*	*P-2/1*	*NPO*	*GS*	*LL*	*Military advisers/ observers*	*United Nations Guard Unit personnel*	*United Nations police*	*Government-provided personnel*	*Total*
United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia													
Approved 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	120	–	–	–	120
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**120**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**120**
BINUH													
Approved 2026[f]	1	1	1	–	–	–	1	–	–	–	48	3	55
Proposed 2027	**1**	**1**	**1**	**2**	**–**	**1**	**1**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**5**	**10**	**23**
UNAMA													
Approved 2026[g]	–	–	2	–	–	1	–	1	1	–	–	–	5
Proposed 2027	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**4**
Subtotal, continuing missions													
Approved 2026	**1**	**2**	**7**	**3**	**1**	**4**	**1**	**3**	**123**	**234**	**49**	**10**	**438**
Abolishment	**–**	**–**	**(1)**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**(43)**	**–**	**(44)**
Establishment	**–**	**–**	**–**	**2**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**–**	**–**	**–**	**7**	**11**
Proposed 2027	**1**	**2**	**6**	**5**	**1**	**5**	**1**	**4**	**123**	**234**	**6**	**17**	**405**
Discontinuing missions													
UNTMIS													
Approved 2026: as at 1 January 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	625	12	20	657
Abolishments in 2026[h]	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	(625)	(12)	(20)	(657)
Approved 2026: as at 31 December 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Proposed 2027	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	**–**	**–**	–	–

	General temporary assistance positions								Other personnel				
	International staff					National staff							
	D-1	P-5	P-4	P-3	P-2/1	NPO	GS	LL	Military advisers/ observers	United Nations Guard Unit personnel	United Nations police	Government-provided personnel	Total
UNMHA													
Approved 2026: as at 1 January 2026	–	–	1	1	–	–	–	–	–	9	–	–	11
Abolishments in 2026[i]	–	–	(1)	(1)	–	–	–	–	–	(9)	–	–	(11)
Approved 2026: as at 31 December 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Proposed 2027	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–

[a] The P-4 and P-2 positions were approved as general temporary assistance by the General Assembly in its resolution 77/263 A, section V, on the recommendation of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions (A/77/7/Add.2, paras. 10–11).

[b] The P-2 position was approved (effective 1 April 2026) as general temporary assistance by the Assembly in its resolution 80/254 and the P-3 position was approved (effective 1 April 2026) as general temporary assistance by the Assembly in the same resolution, on the recommendations of the Advisory Committee (A/80/7/Add.30, para. 41)

[c] The P-3 position was approved as general temporary assistance by the Assembly in its resolution 80/254, on the recommendations of the Advisory Committee (A/80/7/Add.30, para. 26 (b)).

[d] The LL position was approved as general temporary assistance by the Assembly in its resolution 73/279 A, section XIV, para. 28.

[e] The P-5 position was approved as general temporary assistance by the Assembly in its resolution 76/246 A, section X, on the recommendation of the Advisory Committee (A/76/7/Add.1, para. 29).

[f] The D-1 position was approved as general temporary assistance by the Assembly in its resolution 74/263, section XVIII, para. 28. The P-5, P-4 and GS (OL) positions were approved as general temporary assistance by the Assembly in the same resolution, on the recommendation of the Advisory Committee (A/74/7/Add.24, para. 30).

[g] A P-5 position was approved as general temporary assistance by the Assembly in its resolution 77/4, on the recommendation of the Advisory Committee (A/76/7/Add.41, para. 21) and was later reclassified on 1 July 2026 as a P-4 in General Assembly resolution 80/243 A. One P-4 position was approved as general temporary assistance by the Assembly in its resolution 77/263 A, section V, on the recommendation of the Advisory Committee (A/77/7/Add.5, para. 18).

[h] Reflects the repatriation of 625 United Nations Guard Unit personnel, 12 United Nations police personnel and 20 government-provided personnel by 31 October 2026.

[i] Reflects the abolishment of 1 P-4 and 1 P-3 general temporary position as at 31 March 2026 and 9 United Nations monitors repatriated by 28 February 2026.

Table 13
Human resources: posts funded from extrabudgetary resources

	International staff posts											*National staff posts*				*UNV*			
	USG	*ASG*	*D-2*	*D-1*	*P-5*	*P-4*	*P-3*	*P-2/1*	*Subtotal*	*FS*	*Subtotal*	*NPO*	*GS*	*LL*	*Subtotal*	*International*	*National*	*Subtotal*	*Total*
Office of the Special Adviser to the Secretary-General on the Prevention of Genocide																			
Projected 2026	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1
Projected 2027	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Horn of Africa																			
Projected 2026	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	1	2	–	2	–	–	1	1	–	1	1	4
Projected 2027	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	1	2	–	2	–	–	1	1	–	1	1	4
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Great Lakes Region of Africa																			
Projected 2026	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1
Projected 2027	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	1	1	–	1	2	–	–	–	3
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen																			
Projected 2026	–	–	–	1	1	3	2	–	7	–	7	4	–	1	5	–	–	–	12
Projected 2027	–	–	–	1	1	3	2	–	6	–	6	4	–	1	5	–	–	–	11
Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General on Myanmar																			
Projected 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	1	2	–	3	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	2
Projected 2027	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Office of the Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Sudan																			
Projected 2026	–	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	2	1	3	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	3
Projected 2027	–	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	2	1	3	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	3
Cluster II																			
Support to the Security Council Committee established pursuant to resolution 1540 (2004) on the non-proliferation of all weapons of mass destruction																			
Projected 2026	–	–	–	–	–	2	1	–	3	–	3	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	3
Projected 2027	–	–	–	–	–	2	1	–	3	–	3	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	3
Cluster III																			
UNOWAS																			
Projected 2026	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1
Projected 2027	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1

	International staff posts											*National staff posts*				*UNV*			
	USG	*ASG*	*D-2*	*D-1*	*P-5*	*P-4*	*P-3*	*P-2/1*	*Subtotal*	*FS*	*Subtotal*	*NPO*	*GS*	*LL*	*Subtotal*	*International*	*National*	*Subtotal*	*Total*
UNOCA																			
Projected 2026	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1
Projected 2027	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1
UNSMIL																			
Projected 2026	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	3	3	–	–	–	3
Projected 2027	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	3	3	–	–	–	3
UNAMA																			
Projected 2026	–	–	–	–	1	2	7	–	10	5	15	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	15
Projected 2027	–	–	–	–	–	1	5	–	6	4	10	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	10
Total																			
Projected 2026	**–**	**–**	**–**	**2**	**3**	**11**	**11**	**2**	**29**	**6**	**35**	**4**	**–**	**5**	**9**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**45**
Projected 2027	**–**	**–**	**–**	**1**	**2**	**10**	**8**	**1**	**22**	**5**	**27**	**5**	**–**	**6**	**11**	**1**	**–**	**1**	**39**

Note: Posts indicated in table 13 are those funded or projected to be funded from extrabudgetary resources in the current and forthcoming years, based on the most recent information available and projections made at the time of reporting. In keeping with established practice, the table does not include extrabudgetary general temporary assistance positions, positions that are billed to a third party or project posts that are not expected to be funded continuously for more than one year.

VI. Financial performance of special political missions for 2025

142. The General Assembly approved an overall appropriation for 2025 of $693.0 million for the special political missions (resolutions 79/258 A and 79/258 B). Expenditure for 2025 amounted to $632.4 million, resulting in an overall unencumbered balance of $60.6 million, or 8.7 per cent. The overall implementation rate of 91.3 remains consistent with the previous year (92 per cent in 2024) owing to continued spending restrictions imposed as a result of the liquidity constraints and the efforts to curtail expenditure across special political missions. An analysis of the main factors affecting budget performance is provided in table 17. Performance reporting has been enhanced through the inclusion of information for field-based missions in the financial performance report on the programme budget for 2025 (A/81/78), in line with the recommendation of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions (A/79/7/Add.1, para. 10). Further details are also included in the supplementary information under each thematic cluster.

Table 14
Main factors affecting budget performance in 2025

Group of expenditure	*Main factors for variance*
Military and police personnel (underexpenditure of $2.4 million)	The variance was attributable primarily to: (a) the lower-than-planned deployment of United Nations police officers in BINUH; (b) lower costs for rations due to the use of the existing stock reserve and lower-than-estimated costs for contingent-owned equipment self-sustainment due to the non-deployment of equipment in the minor engineering category in UNTMIS; (c) lower-than-estimated costs for the rotation of military contingent personnel in UNAMI; and (d) lower-than-estimated requirements for claims for death and disability compensation. Underexpenditure was offset in part by additional expenditure for military observers in the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia attributable to an increase in mission subsistence allowance rates.
Civilian personnel (overexpenditure of $20.7 million)	The variance was attributable primarily to: (a) the higher-than-budgeted staff costs upon separation from services in UNAMI for which only a partial provision was approved in the 2025 budget; (b) unbudgeted separation of staff costs as part of the two early separation programmes launched and approved in the Secretariat in 2025; (c) an increase in the contribution costs towards health plan subsidy costs for national staff; and (d) updated salary scales for national staff. Overexpenditure was offset in part by broadly higher-than-budgeted average vacancy rates as a result of hiring restrictions.
Operational costs (underexpenditure of $78.9 million)	The variance reflects the austerity measures implemented to contain expenditure and lower-than-budgeted consumption in some areas, attributable primarily to: (a) lower requirements for facilities and infrastructure in UNTMIS, UNSMIL, UNAMA, the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia, UNMHA and the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen; (b) reduced requirements for air operations in UNAMA, UNTMIS, the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia, UNOWAS and UNSMIL; (c) reduced requirements for communications and information technology due to lower costs for communication carrier and network services, curtailed maintenance and support services, the renewal only of essential licences and software, and the suspension of public information and publication services for outreach; (d) the postponed acquisition of equipment, supplies and spare parts with the related reduction in freight costs; (e) the cancellation of planned official travel; (f) the suspension of planned workshops and retreats; and (g) reduced requirements for experts due to vacancies in some panels of experts and mechanisms supporting sanctions.

143. Table 15 provides an analysis of the overall financial performance for special political missions for the period from 2023 to 2025.

Table 15
Synopsis of financial performance for special political missions, 2023–2025
(Thousands of United States dollars)

Category	*2023*	*2024*	*2025*
Appropriation	768 335.0	742 016.9	693 041.2
Expenditure	750 575.9	682 454.9	632 404.9
Unencumbered balance	17 759.1	59 562.0	60 635.3
Unencumbered balance as a percentage of appropriation	2.3	8.0	8.7
Unliquidated obligations	45 438.2	23 422.5	29 258.9
Unliquidated obligations as a percentage of appropriation	5.9	3.2	4.2
Cancelled prior-period obligations	10 292.3	11 224.1	3 607.0

144. Cancelled prior-period commitments in 2025 amounting to $3.6 million in special political missions were due primarily to: (a) the cancellation of the construction of a perimeter wall in Khawkhah due to the uncertainty of funding in future periods to complete the project in UNMHA; (b) lower-than-estimated actual costs for the UNSMIL cost-shared portion of rental space at the Benghazi hub; (c) the cancellation of commitments for the construction of overhead protection and medical supplies due to the inability of the vendors to deliver in UNTMIS; (d) reduced commitments for ground transportation due to the security situation in Haiti, which led to lower-than-estimated actual costs for the maintenance of vehicles and the non-requirement for custom and freight costs for vehicles that were acquired but had to be trans-shipped to UNLB; (e) lower actual travel costs compared with the amounts initially for military observers in the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia due to changes in travel duration; and (f) lower-than-estimated costs for termination indemnity, repatriation grant, commutation of annual leave and other entitlements that were due to staff upon their separation of service from UNITAD, which closed in September 2024.

145. Unliquidated commitments, which remained open at the end of 2025 in special political missions, amount to $29.3 million or 4.2 per cent of the appropriation. Of the $29.3 million, $19 million, or 65.9 per cent, relates to a fund commitment raised in UNAMI for separation costs and salary obligations due to staff upon their separation of service in 2025. Other commitments relate to liabilities for standard troop reimbursements and contingent-owned equipment: major equipment raised in UNTMIS, UNSMIL and UNAMI, accruals for a recreational leave allowance in UNTMIS and the United Nations Verification Mission in Colombia due to late submission of expense reports, accruals for contractual services rendered in UNTMIS, UNSMIL and the Verification Mission, which were pending submission of invoices at year end, and open purchase orders that were pending the delivery of goods or receipt of invoices at year end, mainly in UNAMA.

Annex I

Definitions

A. Terminology related to proposed changes in human resources

1. The following terms have been applied with respect to proposed changes in human resources:

- **Post establishment**: a new post is proposed to be established when additional resources are necessary and when it is not possible to redeploy resources from other offices or otherwise accommodate specific activities from within existing resources.
- **Post reassignment**: an approved post that was intended to cover a certain function is proposed to implement other priority mandated activities unrelated to the original function. While a post reassignment may involve a change of location or office, it does not change the category or level of the post.
- **Post redeployment**: an approved post is proposed to be redeployed to cover comparable or related functions in another office.
- **Post reclassification**: an approved post is proposed to be reclassified (upgraded or downgraded) when the duties and responsibilities of the post have changed substantially.
- **Post abolishment**: an approved post is proposed to be abolished if it is no longer needed to implement the activities for which it was approved or to implement other priority mandated activities within the mission.
- **Post conversion**: three possible options for post conversion are as follows:
  - Conversion of general temporary assistance positions to posts: approved positions financed under general temporary assistance are proposed for conversion to posts if the functions being performed are of a continuing nature.
  - Conversion of international staff posts to national staff posts: approved international staff posts are proposed for conversion to national staff posts.
  - Conversion of the approved source of funding: positions funded under extrabudgetary resources are proposed for conversion to be funded under the regular budget. Other attributes of the positions would remain unchanged.

B. Terminology related to variance analysis

2. The contributing factors for the resource variance according to specific standard options encompass the following categories listed below:

- **New and expanded mandates**: variances caused by changes in the scale or scope of the mandate.
- **Technical adjustments**: variances caused by adjustments due to increased provisions for posts approved for the preceding budget proposals with a 50 per cent vacancy rate that are subject to the proposed vacancy rate for continuing posts in the current proposed budget period. Other adjustments of a technical nature include changes in salary rates, vacancy rates, contractual rates or other changes in cost parameters as a result of United Nations regulations, rules and policies.
- **Other changes**: variances caused by resource changes that do not fall under the above factors.

Annex II

Summary of follow-up action taken to implement decisions and requests made by the General Assembly, including the requests and recommendations of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions endorsed by the Assembly

A. General Assembly

Brief description of the recommendation or request	*Action taken to implement the recommendation or request*
Resolution 80/243	
Stresses that the UN80 Initiative is not a liquidity management measure, and requires going beyond a one-time reform exercise to also incorporate a culture of efficiency to ensure long-term effective and efficient mandate delivery, affirms the respective roles of the General Assembly and the Security Council with regard to special political missions, and requests the Secretary-General to pursue synergies to achieve greater efficiency in the management of post and non-post resources, and to this end present proposals in his next budget submissions, while taking into account the different sizes, complexities and operational environments of special political missions (sect. XVII, para. 4).	Information on the efforts of the Secretariat to pursue synergies is detailed under the section on building and strengthening a culture of efficiency (see paras. 88–93 above).
Recognizes the need to assess the impact of the reform efforts on mandate implementation, requests the Secretary-General to reflect thereon in his future budget submissions for special political missions, and also requests the Secretary-General to explore measures to apply zero-based budgeting, based on mandated activities (sect. XVII, para. 5).	Where applicable, the proposed programme plan for 2027 reflects changes arising from the UN80 Initiative. In particular, the tables of deliverables for each mission reflect updated planned deliverables for 2026, in line with the approved programme budget for 2026. Such changes, as applicable, are articulated in the relevant thematic cluster report. Information on improved budgeting methodologies, including the continued application of zero-based budgeting, is detailed in paragraph 94 of the present report.

B. Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions

Brief description of the recommendation or request	*Action taken to implement the recommendation or request*
Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions (A/80/7/Add.10), as endorsed by the General Assembly in its resolution 80/243 A	
The Advisory Committee notes that there are 3 posts proposed for conversion from international to national posts (including 2 National Professional Officer) and 11 national posts proposed for establishment for 2026. The Committee notes, however, that eight of the new posts proposed for establishment are proposed in conjunction with the proposed abolishment of eight national posts (see A/80/7/Add.14, paras. 21 and 25). The Committee notes with concern that the revised estimates contain only a	As part of the budget formulation process, missions were required to consider options for greater nationalization of functions, commensurate with mandate requirements and operational needs. The section on promoting national capacities (see paras. 60–63 above) contains information on the continued efforts by the special political missions to

Brief description of the recommendation or request	*Action taken to implement the recommendation or request*
limited number of proposals aimed at nationalization and the creation of national posts. The Committee is of the view that the current proposals do not take advantage of the review exercise to enhance national capacity development while adopting cost effective measures. The Committee trusts that a more strategic approach, including the identification of functions conducive to nationalization, will guide continuing efforts in the context of the UN80 Initiative and beyond and that information in that regard will be presented in future budget reports (para. 32).	promote the nationalization of posts in response to the recommendation of the Advisory Committee.
The Advisory Committee has acknowledged the efforts made by the Secretariat to achieve cost efficiency, including by strengthening a data-driven approach in formulating budgetary requirements for air operations for special political missions. The Committee notes the measures undertaken to seek efficiencies and enhance the utilization of air fleets by maximizing opportunities for the sharing of air assets across missions and a portfolio of standby air solutions. The Committee trusts that efforts will be continued to ensure that the air fleets in the missions are used in the most effective and efficient manner, such as by exploring the possibility of refining the applied methodology to attribute greater weight to the latest utilization data, and that information in that regard will be provided in the next budget report. The Committee considers that there are possibilities for more cooperation among missions, in particular those located within the same proximity, with a view to ensuring the efficient and effective use of missions' resources, as an important element of consolidation of the culture of efficiency in field operations, without prejudice to the implementation of mandates of individual missions. The Committee is also of the view that enhanced system-wide cooperation in the context of the UN80 Initiative presents an opportunity also to explore opportunities for further cooperation in the use of air assets, as appropriate. The Committee considers that Headquarters should provide guidance and proposals to missions on possible optimal arrangements of their air fleet and mechanisms for inter-mission cooperation with a view to promoting optimization and cost effectiveness of the use of resources (see A/79/724, paras. 41–42; and A/79/7/Add.1, para. 48) (para. 38).	The Secretariat has taken measures to seek efficiencies and enhance the utilization of the air fleets. The Secretariat continues to implement the category management strategy for commercial and military aviation, which is intended to improve aviation support efficiency and effectiveness, while meeting clients' demands. To increase the Secretariat's agility and responsiveness, the Department of Operational Support has expanded its portfolio of air solutions. In addition to the long-term air charter agreements and military aircraft services under letters of assistance, the Department has increased options for air services to include standby charter agreements, air ambulance services and aircraft services under letters of assistance. In addition, the Secretariat established the On-Call Logistics Capabilities Augmentation initiative in January 2025. The initiative enhances the United Nations ability to respond swiftly in emergencies by leveraging on-call support through pre-established arrangements with Member States. This includes critical resources such as aircraft for evacuation and the delivery of supplies. In doing so, the initiative significantly boosts United Nations surge capacity during crises and the Organization's ability to respond to ad hoc requests, thereby offering improved, efficient and timely support. Missions continue to make efforts to ensure that their air operation requirements are fulfilled in the most effective and efficient manner, including through inter-mission cooperation with other special political missions or peacekeeping missions, when possible. In UNOCA, the Office has reviewed its operational requirement for a dedicated aircraft in view of the non-utilization of the fixed-wing aircraft during 2024 and 2025 owing to liquidity constraints and the high cost of special flights. In response, the Office has prioritized the use of commercial airlines for official travel during the preceding two financial periods and plans to continue this approach, resulting in the removal of the provision for air operations.

Brief description of the recommendation or request	*Action taken to implement the recommendation or request*
	UNAMA continues to explore the use of the regional on-call aircraft charter agreements such as those for the provision of air ambulance and aero-medical and aero-casualty evacuation services. Furthermore, the Mission uses a data-driven approach to plan its air fleet taskings and flight routing, intended to optimize the use of its aircraft. Under the established memorandum of understanding with the United Nations Humanitarian Air Service on cooperation in air operations, UNAMA uses its services when it is more cost-effective to transport its passengers and cargo with the Service's aircraft rather than to task its dedicated aircraft. Because of its geographical location, opportunities for inter-mission cooperation, including with peacekeeping missions, remain limited. Such support would entail long and empty positioning and dispositioning flights. UNAMA therefore requires dedicated aircraft to be deployed to the mission area of responsibility on a continuous basis.
The Advisory Committee considers that efforts should be intensified to maximize the use of virtual meetings and to combine travel, with a view to limiting costs strictly to the minimum necessary. The Committee trusts that further efficiencies under official travel will continue to be explored and presented in the proposed programme budget for 2027 (para. 39).	Missions continue to implement measures to minimize their requirements under official travel, including prioritizing the appropriate use of technology to attend virtual meetings and online training and minimizing travel requirements to attend workshops, conferences and meetings. For the Panels of Experts under thematic cluster II, efficiency gains have been achieved for official travel of staff and expert travel requirements through the use of virtual meetings and the consolidation of travel itineraries, where feasible, as well as through the use of regional meeting formats with intelligence counterparts by the Analytical Support and Sanctions Monitoring Team pursuant to Security Council resolutions 1526 (2004) and 2253 (2015) concerning Islamic States in Iraq and the Levant (Da'esh), Al-Qaida and the Taliban and associated individuals and entities.
The Advisory Committee, while noting the improvement made in the overall compliance rates during 2024, recalls that the General Assembly, in its resolution 77/263 B, reiterated its serious concern at the low compliance with the advance purchase policy directive in all travel categories and requested the Secretary-General to take more effective measures to improve the situation in order to reduce air travel costs, given that most official travel is not carried out for the purpose of emergency situations or unforeseen requirements (resolution 77/263 B, para. 8) (ibid.) (para. 41).	The overall performance for all special political missions has shown increases year on year, from 18 per cent in 2019 to 50 per cent in 2025, reflecting continued efforts by missions to comply with the advance purchase policy and monitor compliance closely to ensure full adherence to policy requirements. Such efforts include the strengthening of internal controls to ensure that official travel is planned sufficiently in advance to significantly reduce air travel costs, the reduction in travel processing times, increased awareness-raising to staff members regarding compliance with the rule and enhanced monitoring of compliance through timely follow-up by travel focal points.

Brief description of the recommendation or request	*Action taken to implement the recommendation or request*
In its first report on the proposed programme budget for 2026 (A/80/7, chap. I, para. 69), the Advisory Committee recalled its recommendation endorsed by the General Assembly in its resolution 79/257 for the Secretary-General to make the arrangements necessary to track information on all expenditures corresponding to the appropriated amounts for training and to report thereon in future budget submissions and financial performance reports. The Committee notes that, while there have been adjustments in missions' proposed resources for training in the context of the revised estimates for 2026, the per capita cost of training has increased in all missions, except UNAMI and the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Horn of Africa (para. 44).	Information on training expenditure is provided in the supplementary information packages.
The Advisory Committee acknowledges the efforts undertaken to identify efficiencies in the budget proposal for 2026 for the special political missions and further efforts in the revised estimates in the context of the UN80 Initiative. The Committee underscores the need for sustainable and quantifiable efficiency measures and gains, with transparent methodology, and an enhanced culture of efficiency for the Organization. The Committee has highlighted efficiencies that go beyond organizational restructuring and be anchored in a rigorous, transparent methodology applied by all entities to ensure consistency and comparability of results and be grounded in systematic workload and performance analysis (A/80/7, chap. I, para. 13) (para. 46).	Information on the efforts undertaken and planned to strengthen a culture of efficiency is detailed under the section on building and strengthening a culture of efficiency (see paras. 88–93 above).
Without prejudice to the distinct mandates of each entity, and subject to the decisions of the legislative bodies, as appropriate, the Advisory Committee trusts that the Secretary-General, in the context of the ongoing UN80 Initiative, will articulate a clearer strategic framework for identifying opportunities for consolidation of United Nations presence, in particular where multiple entities coexist, and for further rationalization of functions, in particular of senior and high-level positions required in special political missions with a smaller footprint, and for strengthened synergies among entities, including clear delineation of roles to be performed by the Missions and by the Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs (see also A/80/7/Add.11, para. 8). The Committee considers that, in the context of constrained resources, efforts should be undertaken for comparative benchmarking among special political missions, enabling systematic assessment of their cost-effectiveness and comparative advantages in implementing mandates (para. 48).	In the context of the UN80 Initiative, the report *Shifting the Paradigm: United to Deliver* outlines concrete steps towards a more streamlined and coherent field architecture. An initial set of measures has been advanced to consolidate and reconfigure selected presences, including integration of UNMHA into the Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen, in line with Security Council resolution 2813 (2026); the closer alignment of the Mission of the Secretary-General's Good Offices in Cyprus with the United Nations Peacekeeping Force in Cyprus, while preserving mandate delivery capacity; and the rationalization of the Office of the United Nations Representative to the Geneva International Discussions through optimized staffing and support structures. These measures, as articulated in the relevant thematic cluster report, reflect a broader shift towards more consolidated configurations, including the reduction in senior-level positions, where appropriate.

Brief description of the recommendation or request	*Action taken to implement the recommendation or request*
	Overall, the proposed budget for 2027 for special political missions reflects a decrease of four high-level posts (D-1 and above), comprising 1 Under-Secretary-General and 3 D-1 posts.
The Advisory Committee considers that the revised estimates for 2026 do not provide comprehensive information on the impact of proposed budget reductions in the implementation of mandates, or on the organizational structure of the special political missions. The Committee trusts that detailed informed in that regard will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of consideration of the present report. The Committee underscores the importance of adopting effective mitigation measures to offset the decreased level of resources and reduce any potential adverse impact on mandate delivery. The Committee trusts that information on the implementation of mandate, along with impact-oriented performance metrics in comparison to past performance, will be provided in the proposed programme budget for 2027 (para. 49).	Detailed information on the impact of the proposed reductions on mandate implementation has been provided to the Fifth Committee during its consideration of the revised estimates. The Secretariat will be further guided by General Assembly resolution 80/251 on mandate creation, implementation and review, with a view to ensuring a more efficient and effective United Nations.
Taking into account the proposals in both the proposed programme budget and the revised estimates for 2026, the Advisory Committee notes that the backstopping posts at Headquarters will be 34 as at 1 January 2026 and 31 as at 1 November 2026, compared with 40 posts approved for 2025. The Committee reiterates its expectation that consolidated information on backstopping positions at Headquarters will continue to be provided in future budget submissions. The Committee trusts that the existing backstopping positions at Headquarters will continue to be reviewed annually, on the basis of workload analysis, in order to realign the capacities when changes in the mandates of the missions occur with a view to achieving more efficiency in backstopping support (see A/79/7/Add.1, para. 54) (para. 54).	Information on resources for backstopping is provided in paragraphs 137 to 141 above, with more detailed information included in the supplementary information package.
The Advisory Committee is of the view that, with the provision of full suite of services to the 10 clients who previously received only payroll and education grant services, administrative capacities in those 10 special political missions must be reviewed for possible streamlining and trusts that information and proposals in that regard will be provided in the next report (para. 56).	Following the transition of Kuwait Joint Support Office clients to RSCE, the Centre will not be providing the full suite of services to all clients at this stage.
With the closure of the Kuwait Joint Support Office as of 30 June 2026, the Advisory Committee welcomes the proposed transfer of the client missions of the Support Office to the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe. The Committee trusts that the transfer will be well planned and coordinated under the leadership of the Department of Operational Support, with adequate resource planning and operational readiness, to ensure a seamless takeover of client missions and timely delivery of services. The Committee trusts that the impact on	The Secretariat acknowledges the Advisory Committee's observations regarding the transfer of Kuwait Joint Support Office client missions to RSCE and affirms that the transition is being executed pursuant to a structured, risk-based framework designed to ensure continuity of operations and adherence to established service standards. The phased sequencing of functions, supported by joint planning, parallel servicing arrangements, defined hypercare periods and retained fallback capacity, is underpinned by robust

Brief description of the recommendation or request	*Action taken to implement the recommendation or request*
service provision to new client entities will be monitored and reported, to better assess both efficiencies and improvements in support to clients, and to track the challenges experienced in the process, to facilitate the adoption of mitigation measures, as appropriate (para. 58).	governance through a dedicated transition oversight team and continuous performance monitoring using key performance indicators, consolidated risk registers and strengthened internal controls. RSCE will continue to systematically monitor and report on the impact of the transition on service provision – supported by enhanced feedback mechanisms and change-management measures – ensuring that efficiencies, challenges and required mitigation action are transparently captured as RSCE assumes full responsibility for the expanded client base in accordance with its established shared-services model.
The Advisory Committee trusts that special political missions will limit new acquisition of new vehicles and laptops, as possible, before undertaking the indicated comprehensive review of the composition of their ground fleet and laptop holdings in view of the reduced footprint, and that information on efficiencies achieved in that regard will be included in the next budget (para. 65).	For 2027, proposed acquisitions for new vehicles or equipment are made following a careful review of the mission's staffing levels and operational needs. Where such needs were identified, missions were required to prioritize the use of existing assets, including the United Nations reserve, strategic deployment stocks, the return, refurbishment and reuse programme and identified surplus property from other entities, prior to proposing the procurement of new items. In the Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon, efficiencies amounting to $438,100 were achieved through cost avoidance related to the non-acquisition of vehicles, equipment or supplies owing to the transfer of assets from UNIFIL in the Office.
The Advisory Committee, while acknowledging specific requirements in field operations, highlights that most of the deviations arise from areas for which the Standard Cost and Ratio Manual does not provide guidance or specify ratios (see para. 67 above). The Committee recalls that the General Assembly expressed concern about the significant variance between the actual vehicle and computing device holdings and standard allocations in special political missions, and in this regard requested the Secretary-General to update the vehicle holding ratio and related guidance, as well as the computing device allocation ratio (in a way that allows the ratios to be relevant), to enable the missions to improve the transparency and accuracy of the relevant budget (see resolution 79/258 A) (para. 69).	The vehicle ratios previously developed require updates to ensure that they remain relevant and reflect current realities, such as the need for vehicles for national staff and experts (in sanctions panels) and the categorization of duty stations, which may give rise to varying safety and security requirements. Subject to the availability of resources, the Secretariat will undertake a comprehensive assessment of client needs to ensure that the resulting ratios effectively support the implementation of their mandates. The Office of Information and Communications Technology has updated the distribution ratios of computing devices to better reflect realistic device allocations and identified areas and staff categories where additional computing devices may be required. This is communicated as part of the annual ICT budget guidelines to all field entities.
The Advisory Committee has expressed the view that it considers there is a need to enhance the performance information, including construction projects, for field-based special political missions under thematic cluster III (A/78/7/Add.1, para. 56; see also para. 58 above). The Committee concurs with the Board of Auditors on the need for more detailed information on construction projects in budget submissions and trusts that the	Information on the efforts of the Secretariat to improve the presentation of financial performance, including construction projects, is provided in paragraphs 118 and 119 above.

Brief description of the recommendation or request	*Action taken to implement the recommendation or request*
recommendation of the Board of Auditors will be implemented expeditiously as soon as possible (para. 70).	
The Advisory Committee notes with concern that the requested information on annual appointments to geographical posts by special political missions, as endorsed by the General Assembly in its resolution 79/258 A, was not provided in the budget submission for 2026, and reiterates that information on annual appointments to geographical posts by mission, level, nationality and representation status should be provided in future budget submissions for the special political missions, with the information from 1 January to 31 December 2025 in the proposed programme budget for 2027 (see A/79/7/Add.1, para. 72) (para. 71).	Information on annual appointments to geographical posts by special political missions is provided in the supplementary information package.
The Advisory Committee notes with concern that, during 2024, the first year since the widening of the posts subject to the desirable ranges system to all posts funded by the regular budget at the Professional and higher categories, including in special political missions, 40.8 per cent of the total appointments and reassignments with geographical status were nationals of overrepresented Member States, while only 20 per cent were of underrepresented Member States. The Committee recalls that the Assembly, in its resolution 77/278, encouraged the Secretary-General to work towards bringing each unrepresented and underrepresented Member State within its desirable range by 2030 and endorsed the recommendations of the Committee, which underscored that additional efforts are needed for progress to be achieved (see A/80/7, para. 52) (para. 72).	The Secretariat acknowledges the Advisory Committee's observation and recognizes that improving geographical balance requires sustained and coordinated efforts. A key challenge remains the limited number of applications from nationals of unrepresented and underrepresented Member States. To address this, the Secretariat is strengthening targeted outreach through partnerships with Member States, universities, professional networks and the broader United Nations country presence, including resident coordinators and United Nations information centres. It is also developing purposeful partnerships to build sustainable talent pipelines and support candidates through capacity-development initiatives that improve their preparedness for United Nations recruitment processes. At the same time, reforms under Staff Selection 2.0 are designed to enhance transparency, efficiency and skills-based recruitment, while improving access and fairness in selection processes. The Secretariat also notes that progress depends on adequate financial resources, given that liquidity constraints can affect the timely filling of posts. Through strengthened outreach, recruitment reforms, strategic partnerships with Member States and adequate resources, the Secretariat aims to achieve sustained progress towards equitable geographical distribution.